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Lecture 1 – 9

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Lecture 01

Concept of Ideology and Its Significance

Micro Learning Outcomes

Students will be able to:

1. Define ideology and recall its basic characteristics and key elements.
2. Understand how religion, culture, politics, and history function as core components in shaping an ideology.
3. Illustrate how ideology contributes to nation-building by applying theoretical concepts to historical or contemporary examples.
4. Analyze the ideological foundations of Pakistan in light of historical developments and political movements in the subcontinent.

1.1 Definition and Meaning of Ideology

Understanding ideology is essential to understanding Pakistan as a nation. The word 'ideology' might sound complicated, but it simply refers to a set of ideas and beliefs that guide how people think about their society, their identity, and their future. Every nation has some form of ideology that helps its people understand who they are and what they stand for. For Pakistan, ideology has been particularly important because the country itself was created based on a specific set of ideas about Muslim identity and nationhood. In this section, we will explore what ideology means in general and then examine how leading scholars and thinkers have defined it specifically in the context of Pakistan.

1.1.1 What is Ideology in General?

At its most basic level, "ideology is a system of ideas that shapes how people view the world." Think of it as a pair of glasses through which people see reality. These ideas influence how groups make decisions and organize societies. An ideology provides a worldview, a sense of identity, gives direction, and creates unity by bringing people together around shared beliefs (Cohen). National ideology helps citizens feel connected to their country. It explains why the nation exists and where it should be heading. Without a clear ideology, a nation may struggle to maintain unity and purpose.

1.1.2 Ideology of Pakistan

Pakistan's ideology is unique because the country was created as a homeland for Muslims of the Indian subcontinent. The ideology came first, and the nation was created to fulfill that vision. This makes Pakistan's case particularly interesting. The concept of 'Pakistanis' combines several elements: religious doctrine, geographical identity, historical narrative, language, and social customs. Together, these elements create a sense of responsibility and belonging among citizens. This ideology provides a national story explaining origins and purpose, defines who belongs to the nation, and offers political goals for leaders. (Cohen)

1.1.3 How Leading Scholars Define Pakistan's Ideology

Stephen P. Cohen's Perspective

Stephen P. Cohen examines the fundamental question of why Pakistan exists. He frames his analysis around the 'idea' behind the Pakistani state that justified creating a separate homeland for Indian Muslims (Cohen). Cohen treats the national idea as central to explaining Pakistan's development, internal tensions, and foreign relations. His work suggests ideology is a living force influencing real political decisions. The 'idea of Pakistan' continues to be debated and contested, showing that ideology remains powerful in shaping the nation's trajectory.

Javed Iqbal's Understanding

Javed Iqbal connected his father's philosophical vision to Pakistan's reality. He emphasized that ideology is rooted in 'Islamic principles', recognizing Muslims as a separate nation with a distinct culture and civilization (Iqbal, 1971). Ideology is deeply spiritual and cultural, encompassing how Muslims should organize society and govern themselves. This makes ideology both a unifying force and a guide for state function.

Sharif-ul-Mujahid's Contribution

Mujahid emphasized the 'Two-Nation Theory' as Pakistan's ideological foundation. This theory holds that Muslims and Hindus are distinct nations with different worldviews and values (Mujahid, 2000). Ideology means "recognizing this fundamental difference and understanding that Pakistan was created for Muslims to live by their values". Religion guides political, legal, and social systems, explaining why religious identity remains central to national identity.

1.1.4 Ideology in Practice

In Pakistan, ideology appears in the education system, textbook narratives, and political discourse. Islam serves as the primary marker that distinguishes Pakistan from its neighbors and unites its diverse internal populations. (Cohen) Political leaders regularly invoke ideology to justify policies and mobilize public support. Ideology, therefore, remains central to understanding Pakistan's identity and development.

1.2 Components of Ideology (Religion, Culture, Politics, History)

Ideology is not just one simple idea. It is made up of different parts that fit together like pieces of a puzzle. The four main components of Pakistan's ideology are Religion, Culture, Politics, and History. These components are closely connected. “Religion” shaped moral values and gave Muslims a reason to demand their own country. “Culture” provided shared practices, languages, and symbols that made people feel they belonged to one nation. The Politics turned these ideas into real actions, like creating laws and government institutions. “History” gave stories and examples from the past that explained why Pakistan was necessary and what it should become. By understanding these components, we can better understand what Pakistan stands for and why it was created.

1.2.1 Religion as the Foundation

Islam as the Core Justification

Religion, specifically Islam, is the most important component of Pakistan's ideology. Pakistan was created to provide a separate homeland where Muslims could live according to their religious beliefs and values. Islam became the philosophical and moral heart of the Pakistan movement. Muslims in British India believed they were a distinct community with their own obligations, customs, and legal traditions. They feared that in a Hindu-majority India, their religious identity could not be protected (Cohen, 1971).

Religion as a Unifying Force

Islam also united Muslims from different regions, languages, and ethnic groups. Before partition, Muslims spoke Urdu, Punjabi, Bengali, Sindhi, Pashto, and others. Islam gave them a common identity that crossed these differences and created solidarity during the Pakistan movement (Mujahid, 2000).

Islam in Governance and Law

Religion influenced governance. Leaders debated whether Pakistan should be a modern democracy or an Islamic state. The 1949 Objectives Resolution balanced these ideas by declaring that sovereignty belongs to Allah, exercised through elected representatives.

1.2.2 Culture as Shared Identity

Cultural Symbols and Practices

Inherited culture came from centuries of Islamic civilization in South Asia, including Mughal traditions, Sufi poetry, and regional customs. Invented culture included new national symbols to unite people, such as the flag, national anthem, and Urdu as a national language. Festivals, art, dress, and social rituals also strengthened a sense of belonging. These practices made people feel connected as one nation while respecting their historical roots (Cohen, 1971).

Language and Literature

Language played a key role in Pakistan's cultural identity. Urdu was chosen as the national language because of its association with Muslim culture and literature. Poets like Allama Iqbal wrote in Urdu and Persian, inspiring the Pakistan movement. His poetry highlighted Islamic civilization's glory and encouraged Muslims toward political and cultural revival. Javed Iqbal notes that "this vision shaped Pakistan's ideology and emphasized intellectual and cultural renewal alongside political independence" (Iqbal, 1971).

Cultural Unity and Diversity

Pakistan's culture includes diversity among Punjabis, Sindhis, Pashtuns, and Baloch, each with unique languages, customs, and histories. The challenge was to build a common national culture while respecting regional differences. Shared symbols like Islamic history, Muslim heroes, and festivals helped create unity. However, different groups sometimes debated which practices best represented Pakistan. Balancing cultural unity and diversity remains central to understanding the country's ideological and social identity (Mujahid, 2000).

1.2.3 Politics as Practical Action

The Two-Nation Theory

The 'Two-Nation Theory' stated that Muslims and Hindus were not just religious communities but distinct nations. Muslim leaders like Sir Syed Ahmad Khan, Allama Iqbal, and Muhammad

Ali Jinnah argued that Muslims would remain a minority in united India and could not protect their political, economic, and cultural rights. This theory became the key political justification for demanding Pakistan, linking identity, security, and sovereignty into a practical framework for a separate homeland (Mehmood, 1994).

Muslim Political Awakening in British India

After 1857, Muslims lost political power and felt weak in education and government jobs. Politics have become essential for survival and progress. Sir Syed Ahmad Khan emphasized modern education and political awareness. The All-India Muslim League was formed in 1906, and separate electorates in 1909 recognized Muslims as a political community. Political awakening gradually developed Muslim identity step by step, ensuring representation, protection of interests, and preparation for the Pakistan movement (Mujahid, 2000).

Constitutional Struggle and Demands for Safeguards

Before partition, Muslims engaged in constitutional debates to protect their future. The Nehru Report (1928) rejected separate electorates, causing concern. Jinnah presented his "Fourteen Points", demanding provincial autonomy and protection of Muslim political rights. Javed Iqbal explains that Muslims realized their rights would not be secure in a Hindu-majority system. Politics became the practical way to ensure representation, self-government, and safety, leading ultimately to the demand for Pakistan (Iqbal, 1971).

1.2.4 History as Legitimizing Narrative

Historical Grievances and Memories

History provides the stories and events that explain why Pakistan was necessary. Historical memory focuses on struggles of Muslims in British India. Events like the decline of the Mughal Empire, the 1857 War of Independence, the Khilafat Movement, and the Pakistan Movement are presented as a continuous story of Muslim resistance and triumph. These narratives give legitimacy to Pakistan's existence. (Mujahid, 2000)

Founding Fathers and Heroes

History creates heroes and role models for the nation. The most important figures are Allama Iqbal, who provided the philosophical vision, and Quaid-e-Azam Muhammad Ali Jinnah, who led the political struggle. These founding fathers are presented as visionary leaders who

understood Muslim needs. Their speeches and actions are studied in schools and quoted in debates to define what Pakistan should be. (Cohen)

History in Education and National Identity

Historical narratives are taught in schools, celebrated through holidays, and reinforced through monuments. Pakistan's education system emphasizes the "Two-Nation Theory", the Pakistan Movement, and the sacrifices made during Partition. This helps create national identity and patriotism among citizens. However, historians point out that historical narratives can be selective. They may emphasize certain events while ignoring others. (Mehmood, 1994)

1.5 How the Four Components Work Together

The four components do not work separately. They are deeply interconnected and support each other. "Religion" provided the moral foundation and main justification. "Culture" supplied shared identity through customs and symbols. "History provided legitimizing narratives and heroes. Together they form a complete ideology that guides the nation. When they work in harmony, they create unity. When they conflict, they lead to division (Iqbal, 1971). Pakistan's ideology is not static. It faces challenges and continues to be debated and reinterpreted (Cohen).

1.6 Importance of Ideology in Nation-Building

When a new country is born, it faces a big challenge: how to bring different people together and make them feel like one nation. This is where ideology becomes very important. Ideology helps in nation-building in three main ways: it creates unity among people, it gives the nation a clear purpose, and it provides a framework for building state institutions.

1.6.1 Creating Unity Among People

The first important job of ideology is to unite people. When Pakistan was created in 1947, it brought together people from different regions and cultures. The Two-Nation Theory gave people a common story to believe in. This ideological unity helped bridge gaps between different regional identities. By focusing on a shared Muslim identity, ideology created a sense of oneness stronger than regional differences. (Mujahid, 2000) This idea became the foundation of Pakistan's identity.

1.6.2 Giving the Nation a Clear Purpose

The second important role of ideology is to give a nation a sense of purpose. A country needs to know what it is trying to achieve. Ideology provides this direction. In Pakistan, the ideological foundation helped define what the state should do. The purpose was to provide a place where Islamic values of justice, equality, and brotherhood could be practiced. (Iqbal, 1971) This gave the nation a moral mission. It influenced everything from education to government communication. A clear ideological goal helps mobilize citizens to work together.

1.6.3 Providing a Framework for State Institutions

The third key role of ideology is to provide a framework for building state institutions. Institutions need guiding principles to function. In Pakistan, ideological principles were built into early political and legal structures. (Mehmood, 1994) The Objectives Resolution of 1949 used ideological language to set rules for the future constitution. It declared that sovereignty belongs to Allah and the state would follow democracy and social justice as explained by Islam. This provided a blueprint for development and gave leaders values to guide decisions.

In short, ideology acts like glue that holds a diverse nation together, a compass that gives direction, and a foundation for state institutions. For Pakistan, ideology was essential for surviving the early years and creating a unique national identity.

1.7 Ideological Foundations of Pakistan

The ideology of Pakistan is the set of beliefs that led to the creation of a separate country for the Muslims of the Subcontinent. It acts as the soul of the nation. To understand this foundation, we can look at four main pillars that supported the demand for a new state.

1.7.1 Islamic Way of Life

The most important foundation of Pakistan is "Islam". For the Muslims of India, Islam was not just personal worship; it was a complete way of life. They believed their spiritual, social, and moral values were different from those of other communities. They wanted a country where they could practice these values in every part of their lives. (Iqbal, 1971) Quaid-e-Azam saw Islam as a source of social justice. He wanted to create a state that protected the poor and treated everyone with equality. This foundation gave the Pakistan movement a moral purpose. (Ahmed, 1997)

1.7.2 Two Distinct Nations (Two-Nation Theory)

The Two-Nation Theory is the idea that Muslims and Hindus were not just two religious groups, but two separate nations. They had different histories, heroes, and ways of living. These differences were so deep that they could never be merged into one Indian nationality. This theory was the political heart of the movement. It convinced Muslims they had a natural right to their own separate country. Without this belief, Muslims would have remained a permanent minority in a united India, always ruled by the majority. (Mehmood, 1994)

1.7.3 Cultural and Linguistic Identity

Over hundreds of years, the Muslims of South Asia developed a unique culture. The Urdu language was a huge part of it. Muslims worried about their culture being erased. They feared that in a united India; their traditions would be replaced by the majority culture. (Aziz, 1967) Muslim identity brought people together from different provinces. Their shared cultural and religious identity gave them a common voice. This foundation was about the survival of a unique way of life. They needed separate land to keep their traditions alive for their children. (Jalal, 2014)

1.7.4 Economic and Political Security

The demand for Pakistan was also about being safe and prosperous. Muslims in British India often found it hard to get good jobs and opportunities compared to other groups. They feared that in a united India; they would always be poor and powerless. Some scholars say the Muslim League wanted political security. This means they wanted to oversee their own destiny. Only in a separate state could they make their own laws and manage their own money without fear of being dominated. (Cohen) By having their own country, Muslims could build factories, schools, and hospitals, ensuring their people could grow in peace.

Concluding Remarks

These four foundations, the Islamic Way of Life, the Two-Nation Theory, the protection of Culture and Language, and the need for Economic and Political Security, joined together to create the Ideology of Pakistan. They provided the vision and the strength for the people to struggle for an independent homeland where they could live according to their own beliefs. This lecture covered the concept of ideology, including its meaning and definition, as well as its four components: religion, culture, politics, and history. The discussion then focused on the importance of ideology in nation-building, followed by an explanation of the ideological foundations of Pakistan.

Lecture 2

Decline of Muslim Rule in the Subcontinent and War of Independence 1857

Micro Learning Outcomes

Students will be able to:

- Identify the major causes behind the decline of Muslim rule in India.
- Understand how internal weaknesses of the Mughal Empire contributed to the loss of Muslim political power.
- Analyze the social, religious, economic and political challenges faced by Muslims after 1857 and their impact on Muslim identity.

2.1 Reasons of Decline of Muslim Rule in India

The decline of Muslim rule in India is a multifaceted historical process that significantly shaped the geopolitical landscape of the Subcontinent, ultimately paving the way for British colonial dominance and the eventual partition of India. This complex period is crucial for understanding the ideological foundations that led to the creation of Pakistan. The collapse of the Mughal Empire, internal weaknesses, and the rise of European powers collectively contributed to the erosion of Muslim political hegemony (Cohen, 2004).

2.1.1 Internal Decay of the Mughal Empire

The Mughal Empire, which had for centuries represented the zenith of Muslim power in India, began its irreversible decline after the death of Emperor Aurangzeb in 1707. While Aurangzeb's long reign (1658–1707) saw the empire reach its greatest territorial extent, it also sowed the seeds of its disintegration. His policies, often perceived as religiously intolerant and fiscally demanding, alienated significant sections of the population, particularly the Marathas and Sikhs, leading to widespread rebellions and protracted warfare. These military campaigns, though initially successful in expanding the empire, severely strained its financial and administrative resources (Aziz, 2002).

Following Aurangzeb's death, a succession of weak and ineffective emperors ascended the throne, leading to a rapid fragmentation of central authority. The Mughal court became a hotbed of intrigue and factionalism, with powerful nobles and regional governors (*Subahdars*) increasingly asserting their independence. This internal instability was exacerbated by the *Jagirdari* crisis, where the demand for land assignments (*jagirs*) outstripped their availability, leading to corruption, reduced loyalty, and a decline in administrative efficiency. Military discipline also deteriorated as emperors relied on mercenary armies whose loyalty was often fleeting. Key provinces like Bengal, Awadh, and Hyderabad gradually became de facto independent states, acknowledging Mughal suzerainty only in name. This decentralization of power effectively dismantled the unified administrative structure that had been a hallmark of Mughal rule (Ziring, 1997).

2.1.2 Rise of Regional Powers and External Invasions

As the Mughal central authority weakened, various regional powers emerged, challenging the remnants of Muslim dominance. The Marathas, under dynamic leaders like *Shivaji* and later the Peshwas, expanded their influence across central and western India, frequently raiding Mughal territories and establishing a formidable confederacy. Their continuous military pressure further depleted Mughal resources and prestige. Similarly, the Sikhs in Punjab, the Jats around Delhi, and the Rajputs in Rajasthan asserted their autonomy, contributing to the fragmentation of political power (Saeed, 2000).

Compounding these internal challenges were devastating external invasions. The most significant of these was the invasion by Nader Shah of Persia in 1739, which culminated in the sack of Delhi. This invasion not only plundered immense wealth from the Mughal treasury but also shattered the myth of Mughal invincibility, exposing the empire's vulnerability to external aggression. It also led to the loss of significant territories in the northwest. Following Nader Shah, Ahmad Shah Abdali, the Afghan ruler, launched a series of invasions, further weakening the Mughal state and contributing to the chaos in northern India. These invasions not only destroyed existing infrastructure and economies but also prevented any coherent revival of centralized Muslim power (Mehmood, 1994).

2.1.3 European Colonial Expansion and Economic Disruption

Simultaneously with the internal decay and regional challenges, European trading companies, particularly the British East India Company, began to transition from mere commercial

enterprises to formidable political and military powers. Initially seeking trade concessions, these companies exploited the political fragmentation of India. They forged alliances with regional rulers, often playing them against each other, and gradually built their own armies (Jalal, 1985).

Key battles marked the ascendancy of British power. The Battle of Plassey in 1757, where the British East India Company, led by Robert Clive, decisively defeated the Nawab of Bengal, Siraj-ud-Daulah, marked a turning point. This victory gave the British control over Bengal, a rich and populous province, providing them with significant revenue and resources. Subsequent victories, such as the Battle of Buxar in 1764, further solidified British dominance, granting them the right to collect revenue (*Diwani*) in Bengal, Bihar, and Orissa. The Anglo-Mysore Wars and the Anglo-Maratha Wars progressively eliminated other powerful regional contenders, effectively establishing British paramountcy across the Subcontinent (Khan, 2019).

The British colonial economic policies further disrupted the traditional Indian economy, which had supported the Mughal aristocracy and Muslim artisans. The imposition of new land revenue systems, the decline of indigenous industries due to competition from British manufactured goods, and the overall exploitation of resources led to widespread impoverishment and disempowerment, particularly affecting the Muslim elite who had historically benefited from state patronage and land grants (Mujahid, 2001).

2.2 War of Independence 1857

The year 1857 marks a massive turning point in the history of the Indian Subcontinent. The students of Pakistan's history trying to understand the "why" behind the creation of Pakistan, this event is the essential starting point. Often called the "War of Independence" by South Asian historians or the "Sepoy Mutiny" by British historians, the events of 1857 were a violent and dramatic end to one era and the beginning of another (Cohen, 2004). To understand the decline of Muslim political power and the eventual struggle for Pakistan, we must first understand the watershed event of 1857.

2.2.1 The Immediate Cause: Why Did the Soldiers Revolt?

The rebellion did not begin as a coordinated struggle for freedom but as a mutiny in the army of the British East India Company. The famous and immediate cause was the introduction of the new Enfield rifle. The cartridges for this rifle were greased with animal fat, and soldiers had to bite the end off to load the weapon.

A rumor spread like wildfire among the sepoys (Indian soldiers) that the grease was made from a mixture of cow and pig fat. For Hindu soldiers, the cow was sacred; for Muslim soldiers, the pig was unclean. This was a direct attack on the religious beliefs of both communities. The British had, for years, tried to respect the religious practices of its soldiers, but this one act of insensitivity convinced many sepoys that the British were trying to destroy their faith and convert them to Christianity (Cohen, 2004). This fear was the spark that ignited the tinderbox of accumulated grievances.

2.2.2 The Longterm Causes

While the greased cartridges were the spark, the fire was fueled by decades of political, economic, social, and religious discontent.

Political Causes

The British East India Company expanded its control through war and diplomacy for a century, but the policies of Governor-General Lord Dalhousie in the 1850s proved particularly inflammatory. The Doctrine of Lapse allowed the British to annex princely states where rulers died without natural male heirs, leading to the seizure of Satara, Jhansi, and Nagpur. Indian rulers viewed this as a betrayal of established succession customs. In 1856, the British annexed the wealthy kingdom of Awadh (Oudh) on charges of misgovernment, directly alienating the many sepoys who originated from this region and remained loyal to its Nawab. Simultaneously, the British dismantled the traditional power structures of the Mughal court and Maratha Empire, creating a class of displaced princes and nobles eager to reclaim their lost authority.

Economic Causes

British colonial exploitation systematically drained Indian wealth through heavy taxation and discriminatory trade policies. The Permanent Settlement and rigid revenue demands devastated agricultural communities, while the destruction of indigenous industries, particularly textiles, deprived millions of artisans of their livelihoods. The annexation of prosperous states like Awadh disrupted regional economies and threatened the economic security of military families. For sepoys, British policies regarding service conditions and pensions created direct financial insecurities, making rebellion an economically rational choice for many participants.

Social Causes

Growing fear of westernization dominated Indian society as the British imposed alien cultural values through administrative and educational reforms. Legislation banning sati and permitting widow remarriage, while progressive, was perceived as unwarranted interference in sacred traditions. The promotion of English education and Western legal concepts alienated traditional elites, who felt their cultural identity was under systematic assault. These reforms undermined the authority of community leaders and created defensive reactions among those determined to preserve their social hierarchies and family structures.

Religious Causes

A pervasive fear existed that the British aimed to Christianize India, fueled by increasing missionary activity and government support for Christian education. As historian Ayesha Jalal notes, Muslim leaders invoked jihad against British rule, viewing it as a threat to Islam. This religious dimension transformed political anger into sacred cause. Crucially, the shared perception of religious endangerment created unprecedented unity between Hindus and Muslims, who traditionally experienced tensions but now found common cause against a regime hostile to both faiths, providing a unifying ideology that sustained coordinated resistance.

2.2.3 The Course of the War

The mutiny began on May 10, 1857, in Meerut. Sepoys who had been imprisoned for refusing to use the new cartridges were freed by their comrades. The rebels then marched to Delhi, the symbolic heart of India.

In Delhi, they turned to the ageing Mughal Emperor, Bahadur Shah Zafar, and declared him their leader. This was a powerful symbolic act, as it revived the notion of a Mughal Empire fighting to expel the British. The rebellion spread rapidly across northern and central India.

- In Kanpur, the leader Nana Sahib led the rebel forces.
- In Jhansi, the legendary Rani Lakshmibai, whose state had been annexed by the British, became a military commander and a symbol of resistance.
- In Awadh, Begum Hazrat Mahal took the reins of the rebellion.

For a brief period, Hindus and Muslims, princes and peasants, united against a common enemy. This unity was remarkable. As one historian notes, the revolt symbolized collective identity, "cutting across caste, class, and communal divisions". It was a moment when an "idea of India" based on shared patriotism seemed possible (Cathie Carmichael, 2023).

However, this unity was not enough. The British had superior resources, better communication, and crucial support from some Indian princes and groups. For example, the powerful Sikh princes of Punjab and the rulers of Hyderabad, Mysore, and Kashmir remained loyal to the British and provided them with soldiers. The rebellion was brutally suppressed by mid-1858. Delhi was recaptured, Bahadur Shah Zafar was exiled, and the Rani of Jhansi was killed in battle. (Saeed, 2000)

2.2.4 Post 1857 Scenario and the Birth of the British Raj

The failure of the War of Independence had catastrophic consequences, especially for the Muslims of India.

End of the East India Company: The British government realized that the Company's rule was a failure. In 1858, the British Crown took direct control of India, an era known as the British Raj. Queen Victoria was declared Empress of India. (Saeed, 2000)

The Policy of Vengeance and Suspicion: The British were determined to punish those they held responsible. The Muslims were singled out for particular suspicion. The British believed that the Muslims were the primary instigators of the rebellion, as they were trying to restore the old Mughal order. As Ahmad Saeed argues, the aftermath was a disaster for the Muslim community (Saeed, 2000). They were systematically removed from positions of power and authority. Their property was confiscated, and they were excluded from the army and government services.

The War of Independence of 1857 was a watershed moment. It was the final, doomed attempt of old India to resist the new colonial power. For Muslims, it marked the end of centuries of political dominance and the beginning of a long struggle for survival in their own homeland. The despair and decline that followed 1857 created the conditions for a new kind of politics. Thinkers like Sir Syed Ahmad Khan would emerge from this wreckage, urging the Muslim community to reconcile with the British, embrace modern education, and chart a new path to protect their identity. Thus, the story of Pakistan's creation begins not with a celebration of victory in 1857, but with the painful lesson of its defeat.

3.3 Social, Religious, Economic and Political Challenges after War of Independence 1857

After the War of Independence in 1857, the Muslims of India found themselves in a state of deep crisis. They had lost their political power, their economic strength, and their social standing. However, the most difficult battle they faced was on the socio-religious front. The challenges were not simply about poverty or lack of jobs; they went much deeper into questions of faith, identity, and survival. This section explores the major socio-religious challenges that Muslims had to confront in the late nineteenth century.

3.3.1 The Crisis of Identity and Psychological Defeat

The most fundamental challenge facing Muslims after 1857 was a crisis of identity. For centuries, Muslims had ruled large parts of India. With the exile of the last Mughal Emperor, Bahadur Shah Zafar, the symbol of Muslim political authority was destroyed forever (Ahmed, 1997). The community found itself leaderless and directionless.

This created a deep psychological defeat. Muslims experienced a "trauma of defeat," going from rulers to subjects. The British deliberately targeted Muslims for punishment, confiscating property and excluding them from government employment (Saeed, 2000). This systematic persecution deepened the sense of despair and humiliation. The psychological challenge was worsened by rapid social change from the West. Muslims were deeply divided on how to respond: should they reject everything Western or accept modernity completely?

3.3.2 Educational Backwardness and Intellectual Stagnation

The most serious practical challenge was educational backwardness. Before 1857, Muslims relied on traditional Islamic education. After British rule, English replaced Persian as the official language, and a modern education system was introduced.

Most Muslims refused to attend British schools. They saw English education as a tool of Christian missionaries and believed it would corrupt Islamic values. While understandable, this rejection had disastrous consequences (Jalal, 1985). While other communities embraced English education and filled government jobs, Muslims lagged far behind. By the 1870s, Muslims were severely underrepresented in government, law, and commerce (Khan, 2019). Without modern education, Muslims could not participate in public debates, influence policies, or represent their interests. They were becoming irrelevant in their own homeland.

3.3.3 Economic Decline and Destruction of the Muslim Middle Class

The economic challenge was closely connected to educational backwardness. Before 1857, the Muslim upper and middle classes depended on government service, land ownership, and traditional crafts. British policies after the rebellion systematically destroyed these sources of income.

The British confiscated properties of suspected Muslims. Ahmad Saeed describes how Muslim nobles were reduced to poverty overnight, wiping out the traditional aristocracy (Saeed, 2000). Furthermore, new legal and economic systems favored those who understood English. Muslims, who had rejected English education, could not compete. Traditional crafts declined against British machine-made goods (Ziring, 1997). The community was trapped in a cycle of poverty and backwardness. Without education, they could not get jobs; without jobs, they could not afford education. This decline threatened the community's survival as a respectable entity.

3.3.4 Religious Fears and the Threat of Christian Missionaries

Perhaps the most emotional challenge was the fear that Islam itself was under attack. After 1857, Christian missionaries became more active, often with British support. They established schools, distributed religious literature, and openly criticized Islam.

Ayesha Jalal discusses how Muslim fears of conversion were very real. Many believed the British used education to convert children. Rumors suggested the government planned to interfere with Muslim personal law. These fears were not unreasonable, as some British officials hoped India would become Christian. (Jalal, 2008) The introduction of Western education and customs seemed like a systematic effort to destroy Indian religions. This religious insecurity created immense anxiety, with parents afraid to send children to school and leaders struggling to protect Islamic beliefs.

3.3.5 The Challenge of Disunity and Conflicting Responses

Finally, the Muslim community faced the internal challenge of disunity. Different groups proposed conflicting solutions, creating division rather than cooperation. Some religious scholars argued for completely rejecting British rule and preserving traditional learning. Others believed Muslims must learn English and adopt modern ways to survive. Still others tried to find a middle path. This confusion made it difficult to present a united front for Muslim interests (Aziz, 2002). The absence of strong leadership was a major challenge. The traditional Mughal

leaders were destroyed, and religious scholars had limited practical power. There was no single voice to guide the community through the crisis.

4 Conclusion

The decline of Muslim rule in India, culminating in the 1857 War of Independence, represents a watershed moment that fundamentally transformed the Subcontinent's political landscape. The internal decay of the Mughal Empire, characterized by weak successors, administrative fragmentation, and devastating external invasions, progressively dismantled centuries of Muslim political hegemony. The 1857 uprising, while briefly uniting Hindus and Muslims against colonial rule, ended in catastrophic failure that disproportionately devastated the Muslim community. The British singled out Muslims for systematic punishment, abolishing the Mughal Empire, confiscating properties, and excluding them from positions of power. This political destruction was compounded by profound socio-religious challenges: educational backwardness, economic decline, psychological defeat, and fears of religious extinction under missionary pressure. The community found itself leaderless, impoverished, and politically irrelevant in its own homeland. This period of unprecedented crisis from rulers to subjects created the collective trauma and identity consciousness that would ultimately catalyze the movement for Muslim revival and the demand for a separate homeland.

Lecture 03

Educational Awakening of Indian Muslims: The Aligarh Movement

Micro Learning Outcomes

By the end of this lecture, students will be able to:

- Recall the causes of Muslim educational backwardness after 1857.
- Explain the role of the Aligarh Movement and Islamia College Peshawar in promoting modern education among Muslims.
- Analyze the impacts of educational reforms movements on the intellectual awakening of the Muslims of Sub-Continent and mobilizing that awakening into a concrete political identity and movement.

Educational Backwardness and Reforms (Aligarh Movement, Islamia College Peshawar)

After the War of Independence in 1857, the Muslims of India were in a very bad condition. They had lost their political power and their economic strength. But the biggest problem was their educational backwardness. Without modern education, they could not get government jobs, could not understand the new British system, and could not compete with other communities who were moving ahead. This section explains the educational problems of Muslims and the efforts made to solve these problems through the Aligarh Movement and the establishment of Islamia College Peshawar.

The Problem of Educational Backwardness

Before 1857, Muslims had their own traditional education system. They studied Persian, Arabic, Islamic law, and religion in madrassas. This system had worked well for centuries because Persian was the official language of the Mughal court. Muslim boys who studied in madrassas could easily get jobs in the government or become respected members of society.

But after the British took full control of India, they changed everything. They replaced Persian with English as the official language. They introduced a new education system based

on Western knowledge. Schools teaching English, science, and mathematics were established in all major cities (Jalal, 2014).

The problem was that most Muslims refused to join this new system. They had two main fears. First, they thought English education was a way for Christian missionaries to convert their children. Second, they believed that Western knowledge would destroy their Islamic values and culture (Saeed, 2000).

This refusal to accept modern education had very bad results. The Hindu community, especially in Bengal and Bombay, quickly took advantage of English education. They got most of the government jobs, joined the legal profession, and entered modern business and trade. But Muslims stayed away and became more and more backward.

The situation was so serious that a British government report from 1886 documented the shocking facts. In 1871, the proportion of Muslims to Hindus in government appointments was less than one-seventh. By 1880, it had fallen to below one-tenth. The report also showed that in the Foreign Office staff of 54 officers, only two were Muslims. In the Finance and Revenue Departments, with 75 officers, not a single Muslim was employed. In the Office of the Accountant General of Bengal, out of 181 officers, there was not one Muslim employee. This was happening even though Muslims made up one-third of the population in Bengal and in some districts were two-thirds of the population.

By the 1870s, Muslims were very few in government service. They could not compete for jobs because they did not know English and did not have modern education. Even in areas where Muslims were in majority, like Punjab and Bengal, they were far behind Hindus in education and employment.

This educational backwardness created a vicious cycle. Without education, Muslims could not get jobs. Without jobs, they remained poor. Without money, they could not educate their children. The community was trapped in poverty and ignorance (Ziring, 1997).

There was another dimension to this problem. The British also changed the language policies in ways that harmed Muslims. Before 1857, Persian was the official language in many parts of India. When the British replaced Persian with Urdu written in Persian script, it worked well for Muslims. But later, there were attempts to replace Urdu with Hindi written in the Nagri script in some regions. This created great discontent among Muslims. More importantly, when English became the language of government and courts, Muslims who only knew

Persian and Urdu lost their jobs. The substitution of vernacular dialects for Persian resulted in throwing out of employment a considerable body of Muslim subordinate officers who were totally dependent on government pay for their survival. As one historian noted, the actual impoverishment of the middle class of Muslims dates from this period (Government of India, 1886).

Another problem was that traditional Islamic education had become outdated. It did not teach science, mathematics, history, or modern languages. Students learned things that had no use in the modern world. But at the same time, completely leaving Islamic education would mean losing their religious identity. Muslims needed a solution that would give them modern knowledge without sacrificing their faith.

The situation of Muslims was so bad that some British observers noted that there was scarcely a government office where a Muslim could hope for any post above the rank of porter, messenger, or filler of ink-pots (Government of India, 1886). This was the condition of a community that had ruled India for centuries.

The Aligarh Movement: Sir Syed Ahmad Khan's Great Effort

The man who understood this problem better than anyone was Sir Syed Ahmad Khan (1817-1898). He was a Muslim scholar and reformer who had worked for the British and had seen both worlds. After the 1857 rebellion, he thought deeply about why Muslims had fallen so low and what could be done to lift them again (Ahmed, 1997).

Sir Syed believed that education was the only solution. He said that Muslims must learn English and modern sciences while also keeping their Islamic beliefs. He started what we now call the Aligarh Movement to achieve this goal (Aziz, 2002).

First Steps: Scientific Society and Translation Works

In 1864, Sir Syed started the Scientific Society in Ghazipur. The purpose of this society was to translate Western books on science and modern subjects into Urdu. He wanted to make modern knowledge available to Muslims who did not know English. The society also published two journals: *The Aligarh Institute Gazette* and *Tehzeeb-ul-Akhlaq* (the Muhammadan Social Reformer).

Through these journals, Sir Syed told Muslims that Islam was not against science and modern knowledge. He argued that the Quran itself encourages Muslims to learn and think. He said that blind following of old customs was the real enemy of Islam, not modern education.

The Muhammadan Anglo-Oriental College (MAO College)

Sir Syed's greatest achievement was the establishment of the Muhammadan Anglo-Oriental College at Aligarh in 1875. This college was his dream come true.

The college had a very special purpose. It would teach Western subjects like English, science, philosophy, and history. But it would also teach Islamic studies, Arabic, and Persian. The idea was to create a new generation of Muslims who knew both worlds, who understood modern knowledge but remained proud of their Islamic heritage.

The college was modeled on Oxford and Cambridge universities in England. Sir Syed wanted it to have the same high standards. He raised money from wealthy Muslims and also got support from the British government. In 1877, Lord Lytton, the Viceroy of India, laid the foundation of the college.

The All-India Muhammadan Educational Conference

In 1886, Sir Syed started the All-India Muhammadan Educational Conference. This was an organization that held meetings every year in different cities of India. Muslim leaders, educationists, and reformers would come together to discuss the problems of the community and find solutions.

The conference did a lot of good work. It encouraged Muslims to start schools and colleges in their own cities. It raised funds for scholarships. It created awareness about the importance of modern education. Slowly, the message of the Aligarh Movement spread to all parts of India.

Why the Aligarh Movement Was So Important

The Aligarh Movement was not just about one college. It was a complete movement for the revival of Muslims. This movement gave Muslims a new confidence and a new direction. It showed them that they could be modern without losing their identity (Aziz, 2002).

The movement produced a whole generation of educated Muslims who later became leaders of the Pakistan Movement. People like Liaquat Ali Khan, who became the first Prime

Minister of Pakistan, were products of Aligarh. The Quaid-e-Azam Mohammad Ali Jinnah himself praised Aligarh and called it the "arsenal of Muslim India".

Some people criticize Sir Syed for being pro-British. But we must understand the time in which he lived. After 1857, Muslims were in no position to fight the British. They first needed to become strong through education. Sir Syed believed that cooperation with the British was necessary for survival. His policy was practical, not just loyal (Jalal, 2000).

Islamia College Peshawar: The Aligarh Spirit in the Frontier

The success of Aligarh inspired Muslims in other parts of India to start similar institutions. One of the most important was the Islamia College Peshawar, established in 1913.

The Need for a College in the Frontier

The North-West Frontier Province (now Khyber Pakhtunkhwa) was created in 1901. At that time, there was only one college in the whole province; Edwardes College, which was run by Christian missionaries. Muslim students who wanted higher education had to go all the way to Aligarh or Lahore. This was very difficult for poor families.

The Founders: Sahibzada Abdul Qayyum Khan and Sir George Roos-Keppel

The man who took the lead was Sahibzada Abdul Qayyum Khan (1863-1937). He is called the "Sir Syed of the Frontier" because he did for the Pathans what Sir Syed did for the Muslims of India. He was greatly inspired by the Aligarh Movement and wanted to bring its benefits to his own people.

He got full support from Sir George Roos-Keppel, who was the British Chief Commissioner of the province. Roos-Keppel was a wise officer who understood that educated Muslims would be better partners for the British than ignorant ones. Together, they worked to establish a college that would serve the Muslims of the Frontier.

The Establishment of the College

Islamia College Peshawar was established in 1913. Its purpose was the same as Aligarh: to provide modern education to Muslims while preserving their Islamic identity. The college taught English, science, and arts along with Islamic studies.

The college was built on a beautiful campus of 300 acres near the historic Khyber Pass. It had large halls, a mosque, hostels for students, and playing fields for sports. Students from all over the Frontier Province came to study there.

Connection with Aligarh Movement

The connection between Islamia College and Aligarh was very strong. Many of the teachers at Peshawar were graduates of Aligarh. They brought with them the spirit of Sir Syed and his message of modern education. The curriculum was also modeled on Aligarh.

In fact, when Quaid-e-Azam Mohammad Ali Jinnah wrote his will, he mentioned three institutions that should receive his property: Aligarh Muslim University, Islamia College Peshawar, and Sindh Madrassah Karachi. This shows how important he considered these institutions for the Muslim community.

Role in the Pakistan Movement

Islamia College Peshawar played a big role in the struggle for Pakistan. Its students and teachers actively supported the Muslim League. They spread the message of Pakistan in the Frontier Province, which was otherwise dominated by the Congress and nationalist parties.

The college produced many leaders who worked for the creation of Pakistan and later served the new country. Sahibzada Khurshid, the first student admitted to the college, later became the first Governor of Khyber Pakhtunkhwa after independence.

Impact of Educational Reforms

The educational reforms started by Sir Syed and carried forward by institutions like Islamia College Peshawar had a huge impact on the Muslim community.

Intellectual Awakening

First and foremost, these reforms created an intellectual awakening among Muslims. For the first time after 1857, Muslims started thinking critically about their problems. Sir Syed encouraged Muslims to use reason and rational thought. He argued that Islam was not against science and modern knowledge. He said that the Quran itself encourages Muslims to learn and think.

Through his journal *Tehzeeb-ul-Akhlaq* (The Muhammadan Social Reformer), Sir Syed spread his message far and wide. He challenged the orthodox mullahs who said that modern education was *haram* (forbidden). He gave Muslims a new way of thinking about their religion and their future. This movement gave Muslims a new confidence and a new direction. It showed them that they could be modern without losing their identity (Aziz, 2002).

Political Consciousness

Second, these institutions created political consciousness among Muslims. The students who graduated from Aligarh understood how the British system worked. They knew English, they knew law, and they knew politics. They could represent Muslim interests effectively before the British government.

In 1886, Sir Syed founded the Muhammadan Educational Conference. This organization held meetings every year in different cities of India. Muslim leaders, educationists, and reformers would come together to discuss the problems of the community and find solutions. This conference became a platform where Muslims learned to think collectively about their future (Mujahid, 2001).

The Muhammadan Educational Conference was so important that it eventually became the All-India Muslim League in 1906 (Hussnain Ali, 2023). This was the political party that would later lead the movement for Pakistan. So, the educational movement started by Sir Syed directly led to the creation of the Muslim League.

Spread of Education

Third, these institutions encouraged the spread of modern education to all parts of India. Following the Aligarh model, Muslims established schools and colleges in Lahore, Karachi, Dhaka, and many other cities. The movement became nationwide.

One of the most important institutions that followed the Aligarh model was Islamia College Peshawar, established in 1913. Islamia College Peshawar became a symbol of Muslim awakening in the Frontier Province. It provided modern education to Pathan youth who otherwise had to go all the way to Aligarh or Lahore. The college also resolved what was called the "dichotomy between secular and religious education", it taught modern sciences while preserving Islamic values.

Preservation of Islamic Identity

Fourth, and most important, these reforms showed that Muslims could be modern without losing their Islamic identity. Sir Syed's message was clear: Muslims did not have to choose between their religion and the modern world. They could have both. This was his greatest gift to his community.

The Aligarh College taught Western subjects like English, science, philosophy, and history. But it also taught Islamic studies, Arabic, and Persian. The students who graduated from Aligarh were proud Muslims who also understood modern knowledge. They could compete with anyone in the modern world while remaining true to their faith.

The educational backwardness of Muslims after 1857 was a serious problem that threatened their very survival. But through the efforts of great reformers like Sir Syed Ahmad Khan and institutions like Aligarh Muslim University and Islamia College Peshawar, the community slowly recovered. These educational reforms laid the foundation for the political awakening that would eventually lead to the creation of Pakistan. As Stephen P. Cohen says in *The Idea of Pakistan*, “without the educational revival started by Sir Syed, there might have been no Pakistan Movement at all”.

Conclusion

The educational backwardness of Muslims after 1857 threatened their very survival. Without modern education, they lost jobs, economic position, and political voice. The Aligarh Movement, led by Sir Syed Ahmad Khan, provided the solution. By establishing MAO College, he showed Muslims they could embrace modern knowledge while preserving Islamic identity. This message spread across India. Islamia College Peshawar, founded in 1913, brought the Aligarh spirit to the Frontier. It provided modern education to Pathan youth and produced leaders who actively supported the Pakistan Movement. Together, these institutions created intellectual awakening and political consciousness among Muslims. They transformed a defeated community into one that could demand its rights. As Stephen P. Cohen observes in *The Idea of Pakistan*, without this educational revival, there might have been no Pakistan Movement at all.

Lecture 04

Genesis of Two-Nation Theory:

The Foundational Phase

Micro Learning Outcomes

By the end of this lecture, students will be able to

- Define ‘Two Nation Theory’ and explain the historical background that contributed to the early development of the idea of ‘Two-Nation’ in the Subcontinent.
- Evaluate how Syed Ahmad Khan’s defense of Urdu emphasized Muslim cultural identity and helped in shaping the early concept of the Two-Nation Theory.
- Critically examine the impact of the Urdu Hindi Controversy, Indian National Congress and the Partition of Bengal in reinforcing the idea of Muslims as a separate nation.

Understanding the Two-Nation Theory

To understand how the Two-Nation Theory emerged? we must first clarify what a nation is, then define the doctrine itself, and finally trace how historical and constitutional developments that reshaped the political trajectory of Indian Muslims from a religious community into a self-conscious nation.

What is a ‘Nation’?

In Political Science, a nation is a historically evolved community of people who share common historical experience, cultural traditions, social institutions, and collective political will.

Applied to the Muslims of the Subcontinent, their shared religion, Islamic law, Urdu language, educational institutions, and historical experience of governance reinforced the concept of Muslim nationhood.

Concept: Two-Nation Theory

The Two-Nation Theory states that Muslims and Hindus of the Subcontinent were two separate and distinct nations because their civilizational foundations were fundamentally different. The difference was not only religious; it involved law, social organization, moral philosophy, culture, and political vision. Syed Ahmad Khan was given the title of father of Two Nation Theory who first used the word 'Nation' for the Muslims of the Subcontinent.

Two-Nation Theory: Keystone of Pakistan's Ideology

Ideology of Pakistan was based on the 'Two-Nation Theory' which meant that there were two nations (Muslims and Hindus) living side by side with their distinct characteristics; religion, unique cultural practices, social values, and political interests. This principle became the **foundational pillar of Pakistan's ideology**, providing a clear rationale for the demand for a separate homeland.

Evolution of Two Nation Theory: Historical Perspective

The emergence of the Two-Nation Theory was not a sudden political reaction of the 20th century. It developed through a long historical process in which civilizational identity gradually transformed into structured political consciousness.

Advent of Islam and the Basis of Two Nation Theory

Looking at the emergence of Islam in the world, the Holy Quran has given us a clear understanding of the 'Two Nations' **believers and non-believers**, emphasizing faith as the basis of community and identity. Monotheism, finality of Prophethood (PBUH), purity of soul and good deeds are the essence of Islam. Those who follow these beliefs form one nation, while those who don't belong to another.

(When we see the history of Subcontinent) Many Muslim intellectuals trace the origin of the phenomenon of Two Nation Theory with the arrival of Islam in the region.

In 712 AD, **Muhammad Bin Qasim** entered the areas that now comprise Pakistan and confronted with Raja Dahir in Sindh and former established Muslim authority. This event

introduced Islamic governance, legal principles, and administrative systems into the region that created an institutional presence forming the basis of Muslim historical memory.

Muslim Leaders and Articulation of Idea of ‘Two Nation’

Muslim leaders and scholars gradually articulated the idea that Muslims and Hindus were two separate nations having diverse religious, cultural, and political identity.

In the eleventh century, the scholar **Abu Rayhan Muhammad al-Biruni**, in *Kitab fi Tahqiq ma li'l-Hind* (c. 1030 CE), recorded early civilizational differences. He observed:

“All their fanaticism is directed against those who do not belong to them — against all foreigners. They call them mlecca, i.e. impure, and forbid having any connection with them, be it by intermarriage or any other kind of relationship, or by sitting, eating, and drinking with them, because thereby, they think, they would be polluted.”

He was the member of court of Mahmud Ghaznavi, highlighted the existence of the two big groups following to two different religions. He was also known as the first founder of idea of ‘Two Nation’ presenting it long before the seed of Muslim Nationalism in the Subcontinent. This shows that Hindu–Muslim social boundaries existed long before colonial politics.

During the Mughal period, Muslim scholars reinforced Islamic identity. **Sheikh Ahmad Sirhindi** (Mujaddid Alf-Thani) (1564–1624), in his *Maktubat*, opposed religious syncretism of Akbar and emphasized the supremacy of Islamic law. He categorically created a line between Islam and Hinduism Because one gives us a complete code of life, while the other provides only a social system respectively. He was one of the Muslim reformists who boldly challenged Akbar’s policies of religious amalgamation that undermined Islam. He also stressed that two communities could never compromise on their religious practices.

Shah Waliullah (1703–1762) and Syed Ahmad Shaheed (1786–1831) were key Islamic reformers who worked for the religious revival and political strength of Muslims in the Subcontinent. Shah Waliullah emphasized Islamic unity when Muslim power was weakening due to the rise of the Marathas, Jats, and Sikhs. Later, Syed Ahmad Shaheed led religious and military efforts to protect Islam, reinforcing the idea of Muslims as a distinct community. These

scholars treated Islam as a public system of life, not merely private faith. Their work preserved Muslim distinctiveness during period of change.

Rise of British Rule: Necessity of a Separate Muslim Political Identity

The decline of the Mughal Empire after the death of Aurangzeb in 1707 marked the beginning of Muslim political vulnerability in the Subcontinent. Weakening central authority, political fragmentation, and economic decline reduced Muslims from rulers to a marginalized community. Although their religious identity remained intact, the loss of sovereignty made it increasingly insecure. This situation further deteriorated after the Indian Rebellion of 1857, when British rule replaced Mughal authority completely. Muslims faced severe political, economic, and social setbacks. The British held them responsible for the revolt, leading to distrust, confiscation of property, and exclusion from administration. Meanwhile, Hindus adapted more quickly to the new system, gaining advantages in education and governance. With the introduction of modern institutions and majority-rule politics, Muslims risked permanent marginalization. Consequently, Muslim leaders felt the need for a separate identity to protect their religious, cultural, and political rights.

Syed Ahmad Khan: Reconstruction and Revival of Muslim Identity

Following the crisis of 1857, Sir Syed Ahmad Khan (1817–1898) emerged as a key reformer dedicated to the uplift of Muslims in the Subcontinent. He believed that harmony between communities was essential for stability and therefore prioritized social and educational reform over political confrontation. According to K. K. Aziz in *The Making of Pakistan*, his strategy was based on loyalty to the British, promotion of modern education, and temporary withdrawal from politics to rebuild Muslim strength.

After the Indian Rebellion of 1857, Muslims were viewed with suspicion and faced severe decline in education, employment, and administration. Sir Syed sought to bridge this gap by improving relations with the British through his writings, including *Asbab-e-Baghawat-e-Hind* (1859) and *The Loyal Mohammedans of India* (1860). His aim was to present Muslims as loyal and capable contributors to governance.

He emphasized modern education as the key to progress and worked to establish institutions that would intellectually revive Muslims. Through these efforts, he not only restored confidence among Muslims but also reconstructed their social position. History shows that Sir Syed Ahmad Khan played a leading role in initiating the intellectual, social and political revival of Muslims in the Subcontinent.

Urdu–Hindi Controversy (1867): Idea of ‘Two Nation’

As history tells us that Sir Syed was initially in favor of Hindu-Muslim Unity. He had earlier described Hindus and Muslims as “the two eyes of the beautiful bride, Hindustan,” reflecting his belief in coexistence. The year 1867 was a turning point in history that negated this very idea of Unity of two large communities. That point was Urdu–Hindi Controversy in the United Provinces marked the first major communal rift in modern politics. It was the direct attack on Muslim identity associated with language. Language is a fundamental medium of social and cultural interaction that binds people together and forms the foundation of society. Urdu developed naturally in the Subcontinent; it was not imported as a foreign language but emerged through interaction between local populations and incoming Arab, Persian, and Turkish influences. Its base lies in the local dialects of North India, particularly Khari Boli, which gradually incorporated vocabulary from Persian, Arabic, and Turkish. This linguistic blending gave rise to a new language that later came to be known as Urdu, commonly referred to as “Lashkari Zaban” (the camp language).

During Muslim rule in India, it became closely associated with Muslims and later became a symbol of separate cultural and historical identity of Muslims of the Subcontinent. Urdu had long been associated with Indo-Muslim cultural and administrative heritage.

In fact, Hindu leaders demanded the replacement of Urdu, written in Persian script, with Hindi in Devanagari script for official use in courts and administration. Altaf Hussain Hali in his biography of Sir Syayyid mentioned that Sir Syed became suspicious about Hindu intentions when they started complaining in Banaras for adopting Hindi as an official language. However, after witnessing the agitation, he reportedly remarked that the two communities would not cooperate wholeheartedly in public matters. The controversy convinced Syed Ahmad that cultural divergence could easily transform into political conflict, and this realization reinforced

the urgency of strengthening Muslim educational and economic foundations. Shakespear asked when the controversy was going on, that it is the first time I have heard you speak about the education of Muslims alone. In reply Syed Ahmad said;

“After Urdu Hindi Controversy, I am now convinced that the two nations will not join wholeheartedly in anything.”

Sir Syed Ahmad is known as pioneer of “Two Nation Theory” because he first used the word ‘Qaum’ (Nation) for the Muslims of the Subcontinent and predicted the differences between the two groups would increase with a passage of time. In his letter to Nawab Mohsin-ul-Mulk in 1870, he stressed “Muslims will never agree to Hindi and if Hindus also following the new move insist on Hindi, they will also not agree to Urdu. The result will be that the Hindus and Muslims will be completely separated.”

Another important figure in defending the status of Urdu was Mohsin-ul-Mulk, a close associate of Sir Syed Ahmad Khan and a prominent leader of the Aligarh Movement. Mohsin-ul-Mulk strongly supported Urdu as a symbol of Muslim identity and culture. Consequently, he played a central role in organizing efforts that later led to the establishment of the Urdu Defence Association in the late 19th century which aimed to defend Urdu against the replacement by Hindi in courts and administration. This fact was highlighted that, despite a shared geography, cultural symbols can become subjects of political contestation.

Indian National Congress and Muslims Aloofness from Politics

The formation of the Indian National Congress in 1885 marked the beginning of organized political agitation for representative government. It was founded by A. O. Hume a former Home Secretary of the Government of India. Sir Syed viewed Congress demands cautiously, believing that Congress leadership largely reflected majority interests. He feared that rapid democratization would benefit the Hindu majority while Muslims remained educationally weaker. Therefore, he advised political aloofness until Muslims strengthened themselves sufficiently to compete. His strategy reflected constitutional realism: participation without preparation could institutionalize permanent disadvantage, and this caution shaped his broader reformist vision. In this case, it can't be assumed that he was anti-Hindus. He was friendly towards the Hindus but opposed to the objectives of the Congress. He pointed out that the congress objective of representative

government meant that Muslim would be merged by the Hindu majority. Out of the 70 delegates who attended the opening session of the Congress, only two were Muslims. Syed Ahmad who was invited to attend the Bombay session, refused the offer. He also advised Muslims not to join the Congress and predicted that the party would eventually become a Hindu party and would only look after the interests of Hindus. He mentions his concerns to clear his point of view in his letter to Budruddin Tyabji, the first Muslim President of the Congress, that the logical outcome of Congress agitation would be violence in which Muslims, as in the Mutiny, would bear the burden of consequences.

In response to Indian National Congress, Sir Syed Ahmad founded Muhammadan Educational Conference in 1886 was primarily an educational platform aimed at promoting modern and religious education among Muslims and overcoming backwardness. It also served as a forum for social reform, creating awareness and unity within the Muslim community. Although non-political, it indirectly developed political consciousness that later contributed to organized Muslim politics.

Sir Syed's concerns related to Hindus and Congress proved factual when the Hindu-Muslims riot broke out in Bombay in 1893 on the point of cow-slaughter and the playing of music before the Mosque at the prayer time. He said that "no political movement in India could be depended upon to produce worthwhile results in the face of growing estrangement between Hindus and Muslims". These were the sentiments of Muslims which were truly uttered by Syed Ahmad.

Majoritarianism ("One Man, One Vote") Vs. Separate Electorates

Sir Syed Ahmad Khan rightly pointed out that majority-rule democracy would structurally disadvantage Muslims as minority. In his Meerut Speech delivered on 16 March 1888, he declared:

"Now suppose that all the English were to leave India — then who would be the rulers of India? Is it possible that under these circumstances two nations — the Mohammedans and the Hindus — could sit on the same throne and remain equal in power? Most certainly not."

By the late nineteenth century, Sir Syed Ahmad Khan opposed the proposal for selecting representatives in the Viceroy's council by election. Because Muslims would have no place in the Council, constituted roughly one-fourth of British India's population. The prophecy of Sir Syed

Ahmad Khan came to true. Under Indian Councils Act of 1892, the formation of legislative Council was based on half selection and half nomination. During that time, Muslims were not satisfied with the system even then could not secure single seat of Council. That system did not provide any safeguards, political influence and prestige as compared to Hindus. That's why Sir Syed Ahmad highlighted the system based on "one man, one vote," the Hindu majority would permanently dominate legislative institutions.

He advocated the right of separate electorates for Muslims of the Subcontinent and presented a scheme which stated that Muslims were a distinct community, entitled to elect their own representatives separately in legislative bodies, ensuring the protection of their political rights and interests. Separate electorates reinforced the idea that Muslims were a distinct political community, thereby strengthening the foundation of the Two-Nation Theory.

Partition of Bengal (1905): Demographic Recognition

The Partition of Bengal on September 1, 1905 created Eastern Bengal and Assam, where Muslims formed approximately 54% of the population. For the first time, Muslim demographic strength translated into administrative authority. The partition was announced by Lord Curzon. Officially, it was presented as an administrative measure because Bengal was too large to govern effectively. It divided Bengal into:

- Western Bengal (Hindu-majority)
- Eastern Bengal & Assam (Muslim-majority)

Curzon justified it as an administrative measure to improve governance of a vast province, stating that it would *"invest the Mohamedans in Eastern Bengal with a unity which they have not enjoyed since the days of the old Musalman Viceroys and Kings."*

Muslims' Response to the Partition of Bengal

Muslims welcomed the partition because Eastern Bengal provided them political majority and educational opportunities. It reduced Hindu economic dominance in Calcutta. It gave Muslims confidence in separate provincial strength. Many Muslims leaders appreciated Government because it created Eastern Bengal and Assam, a Muslim-majority province, with greater access to government jobs, education, and political representation. Muslims first saw the benefits of

majority rule in a province, highlighting their separate political interests from Hindus, as noted by Syed Ahmad. Leaders like Nawab Salimullah Khan openly supported the measure, believing it would restore Muslim influence that had declined since 1857.

Hindus' Opposition to the Partition of Bengal

Quite understandably Hindu lawyers, merchants and landlords were opposed to it because partition was lessening the Calcutta's commercial and professional supremacy in Bengal. Strong opposition from Hindu elites, politicians and press was faced by Lord Curzon. The Hindu middle class of Calcutta (lawyers, journalists, zamindars, and educated professionals) viewed Bengal as:

- A symbol of cultural unity.
- The intellectual center of Indian nationalism.

Nationalists believed the partition was a deliberate British strategy of “**Divide and Rule.**” and an attempt to weaken the growing nationalist movement in Bengal. Hindu leaders believed that this was a deliberate act of British government to sow the seeds of differences between two communities Hindu and Muslim. Although Khalid Bin Sayeed quoted Hindu editor Auro Bindo who claimed in *Bande Mataram* “the composite culture of India is undoubtedly Hindu”.

Many Hindu leaders argued that the creation of a Muslim-majority province in Eastern Bengal would reduce Hindu political influence. Thus, their opposition was not only administrative but also political. Consequently, leaders like Surendranath Banerjee condemned the partition as an assault on Bengali unity, and the Bengalis launched the *Swadeshi* Movement whose sole purpose was the boycott of British goods and use of locally manufactured Indian products. Moreover, the dominance of Hindu nationalist leaders within the Congress during the *Swadeshi* agitation reinforced Muslim apprehensions that the organization was evolving into a body primarily safeguarding Hindu-majority political interests, rather than functioning as a genuinely representative of all Indians.

Annulment of Partition of Bengal

After passing the six years, decision of Partition of Bengal was suddenly reversed in 1911 at the Delhi Durbar by King George V. Although, Lord Minto repeatedly assured Muslims about decision of partition while calling it final and unchangeable. British reversed it due to Indian National Congress and Hindu agitation exposed the vulnerability of Muslim political interests. While Hindus celebrated it as a triumph of nationalist struggle. Contemporary Muslim newspapers noted that “the British have caved in to Hindu agitation at the expense of Muslim political hopes.” This event intensified communal divisions and reinforced the perception that Hindus and Muslims had conflicting political aspirations, thereby strengthening the foundations of the Two-Nation Theory. It was an eye-opening event that forced Muslim to think that they would have to fight with two powers in future, the Hindu and the British.

Concluding Remarks

The foundational phase of the Two-Nation Theory established the intellectual and political basis that eventually led to the creation of Pakistan. During this period, Muslim scholars, reformers, and leaders emphasized the distinct religious, cultural, and historical identity of Muslims in the subcontinent. The decline of Muslim political power after 1857, combined with Sir Syed Ahmad Khan’s reformist vision, key developments such as the Urdu–Hindi Controversy, and the Partition of Bengal (1905), gradually shaped Muslim consciousness. Demands for political safeguards, including separate electorates, reinforced the idea that Muslims were a separate nation whose rights could not be secured under a Hindu-majority system. These experiences laid the ideological foundation for the demand for an independent Muslim homeland, culminating in Pakistan’s creation in 1947.

Lecture No. 05

Muslim Political Struggle in British India (1906-1929)

Introduction

The previous lecture was about the emergence and philosophical foundations of the Two-Nation Theory, emphasizing religious, cultural, and political differences that necessitated a separate Muslim identity. The current lecture highlights practical steps toward political recognition, including separate electorates, the formation of the All-India Muslim League and reforms like Minto-Morley and Montague-Chelmsford reforms, and then the Nehru Report and the Jinnah's Fourteen Points.

Micro Learning Outcomes

The students will be able to:

- Recall why Muslims demanded separate electorates and a separate political platform.
- Remember the key provisions of Minto-Morley and Montague-Chelmsford reforms.
- Differentiate between the Nehru Report and Jinnah's Fourteen Points in terms of minority rights and political safeguards.

Separate Electorate

Background and Need

Separate electorates mean a system where minorities elect their own representatives instead of voting jointly. Indian Muslims demanded this because they feared unfair representation in a Hindu-majority system. When the British introduced democracy, decisions were based on majority rule, which worried Muslims that Hindus would dominate politics and ignore their interests. Muslims also believed they were a separate nation due to differences in religion, culture, and traditions. Congress supported joint electorates as it favored the majority. Therefore, Muslims demanded separate electorates to protect their political rights, identity, and future, ensuring their meaningful participation in government and safeguarding their interests (Aziz, 2002).

Prominent People

A key role in presenting the demand for separate electorates was played by Sir Aga Khan, who led the Muslim delegation to the Viceroy. He clearly explained the concerns of Muslims and demanded proper political representation.

Another important figure was the Principal of the M.A.O College Archbold who arranged the meeting of Muslim delegation with the Viceroy on 1st October 1906. Finally, a delegation consisting of 35 leaders of Muslim community met to the viceroy, under the leadership of Sir Aga Khan, in Simla on 1st October 1906. The deputation was included the members from Bengal, Punjab, U.P., Bombay, Madras, Sindh, C.P., Deccan, and Delhi (Saeed, 2000).

The delegation met Lord Minto, who listened carefully and assured that their demands would be considered by the British government. His response encouraged Muslims to organize politically.

Later, Muhammad Ali Jinnah became the most important leader who defended Muslim political rights. He emphasized that Muslims were a separate nation and must have political safeguards.

On the other hand, Mahatma Gandhi and the Congress leadership opposed separate electorates and supported joint elections, arguing for a united Indian nation.

Demands

The formal demand for separate electorates was presented in the Simla Deputation on 1st October 1906. Muslims demanded separate representation at all levels, including legislative councils, municipalities, and district boards. They also demanded that their representation should not be based only on population but also on their political importance and past contributions, as Muslims had ruled India for many centuries.

These demands were accepted in the Minto-Morley Reforms, which granted separate electorates to Muslims. This was a major achievement, as Muslims were now able to elect their own representatives and also vote in general constituencies. Although their representation was less than their actual population, it was still a landmark in their political history.

In the Lucknow Pact, Congress accepted the Muslim demand for separate electorates and agreed to give Muslims one-third representation at the center. It also introduced the concept of weightage, giving Muslims more seats than their population in minority provinces.

Later, the Montague-Chelmsford Reforms continued this system and accepted many demands of the Lucknow Pact. However, Congress later rejected these rights in the Nehru Report.

Elections held under the Government of India Act 1935 and later in 1945 proved that the All India Muslim League was the true representative of Muslims.

The Simla deputation was unique, because for the first time Muslims were anxious to take their share in the political activities as a separate identity. Another purpose of the delegation was to get a silent permission from the Government to make a political platform for the representation of Muslims, and also was to take the Government into confidence. The demand of separate electorates, which were presented through the deputation, was the foundation of all future constitutional amendments for India. The inevitable consequence of deputation was the partition of India and the emergence of Pakistan (Saeed, 2000).

Formation of Muslim League

Introduction / Background

After the creation of the Indian National Congress, it claimed to represent all Indians. However, Muslims soon felt that Congress mainly protected Hindu interests. Leaders like Sir Syed Ahmed Khan had already warned that Hindus and Muslims were two separate nations with different beliefs, culture, and interests.

Events like the Partition of Bengal and the Urdu-Hindi Controversy increased tensions. Muslims realized they needed their own political voice. As a result, the All India Muslim League was established on 30 December 1906 at Dacca. This marked the beginning of organized Muslim politics in India (Saeed, 2000).

Why Muslims Needed a Separate Platform

Muslims felt the need for a separate political platform due to several reasons:

- Congress had an indifferent and often hostile attitude towards Muslim interests.

- Muslims were educationally and economically backward compared to Hindus and needed special attention.
- In the Urdu-Hindi controversy, Congress supported Hindi, ignoring Muslim concerns.
- The announcement of reforms by John Morley made Muslims realize they lacked representation.
- The success of the Simla Deputation encouraged Muslims to organize politically.
- Muslims believed they were a separate nation with a distinct identity and needed protection.

Formation of the All India Muslim League (December 1906)

A resolution to form the All India Muslim League was passed by Nawab Salimullah Khan and was seconded by Hakim Ajmal Khan, Maulana Muhammad Ali and Moulana Zafar Ali. The resolution was passed by All India Educational Conference on 30th December 1906. Sir Agha Khan was appointed as President and Syed Hassan Balgrami as Secretary. Nawab Mohsim-ul-Mulk and Nawab Viqar-ul-Mulk were made joint secretaries. In this way Muslim league was established and become the sole representative of Muslims (Aziz, 2002).

Objectives and Early Growth

The Muslim league laid the following points as its objectives:

1. To create loyalty towards British Government.
2. To safeguard political rights of Muslims.
3. To prevent prejudicial feelings against other communities.

The first session was held at Karachi on 29th December 1907. Later, Syed Ameer Ali organized a branch of Muslim league at London on 6th May 1908.

Analysis

The creation of the Muslim League was a turning point in the political history of Indian Muslims. It gave them a united platform to express their concerns and protect their rights. The acceptance of separate electorates strengthened Muslim identity and political awareness.

Over time, the League became a strong political force, especially under the leadership of Muhammad Ali Jinnah. It transformed from a small organization into a mass movement. The idea that Muslims were a separate nation became stronger, leading to the demand for a separate homeland.

In the end, the Muslim League successfully led the struggle that resulted in the creation of Pakistan in 1947.

Minto-Morley Reforms 1909

Background to the Reforms

By 1909, political consciousness had grown a lot in India. The Indian National Congress and the newly formed All India Muslim League (1906) had become important voices. The British realized that old acts were not working. They needed to listen to these parties to keep peace. Two events pushed the British. First, Japan's victory over Russia (1904-5) gave Indians hope that Asia could become strong (Khan, 2019). Second, the Liberal Party came to power in Britain in 1906. This party did not like the harsh policies of the Conservatives. So, Lord Minto (Viceroy) and John Morley (Secretary of State) introduced new reforms in 1909.

Main Provisions of the Reforms

1. Separate Electorate for Muslims

This was the most important part. For the first time, the British accepted the demand for separate electorate. Muslims would now vote only for Muslim candidates. This gave constitutional recognition to the idea that Muslims were a separate nation.

2. Increased Council Size and Powers

The number of members in the Imperial Legislative Council was increased from 16 to 60. Provincial councils were also made bigger. Members got new powers. They could ask questions, ask supplementary questions, and criticize the government. They could also move resolutions on public issues.

3. Indians in Executive Councils

For the first time, an Indian (S.P. Sinha) was included in the Viceroy's Executive Council. However, Muslims criticized this because they wanted one Muslim member too. The government promised to appoint a Muslim next time. Later, Sayed Ali Imam got this position.

4. Special Representation for Loyal Classes

The government wanted to win support from rich and loyal people. So, special seats were given to landlords, chambers of commerce, and other influential groups.

5. Official Majority Maintained

Despite all changes, the British kept official majority in the Imperial Council. In provincial councils, non-official majorities were useless because nominated members were included. There was no responsible government (Saeed, 2000).

Reactions to the Reforms

The Indians were not fully satisfied. The Congress split into two groups. The Moderates (like G.K. Gokhale) welcomed the reforms. Gokhale said in the Council, "*My Lord, I sincerely believed that you and Lord Morley have saved the country from anarchy and chaos.*" But the Extremists (like B.G. Tilak) rejected the act completely (Khan, 2019).

On the other hand, the All India Muslim League welcomed the 1909 Act. In the Delhi session of 1910, the League passed a resolution offering cooperation to the government.

Positive Contributions

Despite all flaws, the reforms opened the door for real politics. Indians learned to work in legislative councils. For example, 24 resolutions were accepted out of 168 in the Imperial Council. Also, Mohammad Ali Jinnah, as a private member, presented the *Waqf-alal-Aulad Bill*, which was passed (Khan, 2019).

Lucknow Pact 1916:

The Lucknow Pact of 1916 represented a watershed moment in the Indian independence movement, marking the first and only time the Indian National Congress formally conceded to the All-India Muslim League's demand for separate electorates. By signing this agreement, the

Congress effectively recognized the Muslim community as a distinct political entity with specific interests that required guaranteed representation in provincial legislatures.

Montague-Chelmsford Reform (1919)

The reforms were introduced in 1919 under the Government of India Act to increase Indian participation in administration. The earlier Minto-Morley Reforms had failed, so Indians demanded self-government. The Lucknow Pact united Congress and Muslim League. During World War I, Indians supported Britain but later felt disappointed due to unfulfilled promises.

Edwin Montagu and Lord Chelmsford introduced these reforms in the Act of 1919. Main features were:

- **Secretary of State's council:** Council of Secretary of State to have 8–12 members, including at least 3 Indians.
- **Central Legislature became bicameral:** Upper House (Council of State) with 60 members (35 elected); Lower House (Legislative Assembly) with 144 members (103 elected).
- **Division of powers:** center-controlled defense, foreign affairs, and currency; provinces managed education, health, and local government.
- Secretary of State's salary to be paid by the British government.
- **Diarchy in provinces:** Provincial subjects split into Transferred (health, education, agriculture) under ministers, and Reserved (police, land revenue) under Governor. Governor controlled both.

The reforms did not satisfy Indians. Mahatma Gandhi and Congress rejected them as inadequate, while Muslims accepted them with reservations. The Rowlatt Act and Jallianwala Bagh Massacre increased unrest, causing the failure of these reforms.

Nehru Report

Background: Simon Commission and Political Deadlock

Under the Act of 1919, the British planned constitutional reforms in India every ten years. Accordingly, the Simon Commission was sent in 1927, but it was boycotted by most Indian political parties due to lack of Indian representation. Lord Birkenhead challenged Indian leaders to draft a unanimous constitution. In response, an All-Parties Conference was held in Delhi in January 1928, attended by groups like the Indian National Congress and All India Muslim League, but failed over minority rights. Finally, under Motilal Nehru, a committee prepared the Nehru Report.

Key provisions of the Nehru Report were:

1. India should be given Dominion Status with the Parliamentary form of Government.
2. There should be a bi-cameral legislature consisting of senate and House of Representatives. The senate will comprise of two hundred members elected for seven years, while the House of Representatives should consist of five hundred members elected for five years.
3. Governor-General will act on the advice of executive council. It was to be collectively responsible to the parliament.
4. There should be Federal form of Government in India with Residuary powers to be vested in Centre.
5. There will be no separate electorate for minorities.
6. System of weightage should not be adopted for any province.
7. There will be no reserved seats for communities in Punjab and Bengal. However, reservation of Muslim seats could be possible in the provinces where Muslim population should be at least ten percent.
8. Judiciary should be independent from the Executive
9. There should be 1/4th Muslim Representation at Centre
10. Sindh should be separated from Bombay provided it proves to be financially self-sufficient.
11. Reforms should be introduced in NWFP

The report was strongly opposed by Muslims, and its Muslim members did not sign it. In December 1928, Muhammad Ali Jinnah presented four amendments: one-third Muslim representation at the Centre, reservation of seats in Punjab and Bengal, a federal system with

residuary powers to provinces, and separation of Sindh along with reforms in NWFP and Balochistan (Saeed, 2000).

These amendments were rejected by the Congress majority, which demanded implementation of the Nehru Report and declared January 26 as Independence Day. Jinnah termed this moment the “*parting of the ways*,” marking a clear divide between Hindu and Muslim political visions.

Jinnah Fourteen points

In order to counter the proposals made in the Nehru Report, Jinnah presented his proposal in the form of Fourteen Points, insisting that no scheme for the future constitution of the government of India will be satisfactory to the Muslims until and unless stipulations were made to safe guard their interests. The following points were presented by the Quaid to defend the rights of the Muslims of the sub-continent:

1. The form of the future constitution should be federal, with the residuary powers to be vested in the provinces.
2. A uniform measure of autonomy shall be granted to all provinces.
3. All legislatures in the country and other elected bodies shall be constituted on the definite principle of adequate and effective representation of minorities in every province without reducing the majority in any province to a minority or even equality.
4. In the Central Legislature, Muslim representation shall not be less than one third.
5. Representation of communal groups shall continue to be by separate electorates: provided that it shall be open to any community, at any time, to abandon its separate electorate in favor of joint electorate.
6. Any territorial redistribution that might at any time be necessary shall not in anyway affect the Muslim majority in the Punjab, Bengal and the NWFP.
7. Full religious liberty i.e. liberty of belief, worship, and observance, propaganda, association, and education, shall be guaranteed to all communities.
8. No bill or resolution or any part thereof shall be passed in any legislature or any other elected body if three fourths of the members of any community in that particular body

- oppose such a bill, resolution or part thereof on the ground that it would be injurious to that community or in the alternative, such other method is devised as may be found feasible practicable to deal with such cases.
9. Sind should be separated from the Bombay Presidency.
 10. Reforms should be introduced in the NWFP and Balochistan on the same footing as in other provinces.
 11. Provision should be made in the Constitution giving Muslims an adequate share along with the other Indians in all the services of the State and in local self-governing bodies, having due regard to the requirements of efficiency.
 12. The Constitution should embody adequate safeguards for the protection of Muslim culture and for the protection and promotion of Muslim education, language, religion and personal laws and Muslim charitable institutions and for their due share in the grants-in-aid given by the State and by local self-governing bodies.
 13. No cabinet, either Central or Provincial, should be formed without there being a proportion of at least one-third Muslim ministers.
 14. No change shall be made in the Constitution by the Central Legislature except with the concurrence of the States constituting the Indian Federation (Saeed, 2000).

Conclusion

In conclusion, the Muslim political struggle from 1906 to 1929 marked a decisive shift from minority safeguards to a clear demand for political recognition. Beginning with the Simla Deputation and the demand for separate electorates, Muslims asserted their distinct identity. The formation of the All India Muslim League provided a platform to protect their rights. Constitutional reforms like the Minto-Morley and Montague-Chelmsford Acts offered limited progress but failed to satisfy aspirations. The rejection of Muslim demands in the Nehru Report and the response of Muhammad Ali Jinnah through the Fourteen Points ultimately defined a separate political path for Muslims.

Lecture No. 06

Allama Iqbal's Presidential Address 1930

Micro Learning Outcomes

At the end of this lecture, Students will be able to;

Sr. No.	MLO	Cognitive Level of Learning
1.	Identify the background, its session and key themes of the Allahabad Presidential Address (1930).	Remembering
2.	Explain Iqbal's concept of Muslim nationhood and the political significance of Allahabad Address.	Understanding
3.	Analyse the key ideas of the original text of Allahabad Address (1930) by Allama Muhammad Iqbal, including Muslim identity, political autonomy, and Islam as a complete code of life.	Analysis
4.	Relate Iqbal's ideas in the Allahabad Address to the emergence of the Two-Nation Theory and Pakistan Movement.	Application

Previous Lecture Review

The previous lecture covered the period (1906–1929), which marked the beginning of organized Muslim political struggle in British India. The Simla Deputation and the All-India Muslim League aimed to protect Muslim rights. Separate electorates were granted in 1909. The Lucknow Pact ensured cooperation while acknowledging right of Separate Electorates of Muslims. The Nehru Report aimed to propose a united constitutional framework for India but was rejected by Muslims, leading to Muhammad Ali Jinnah's Fourteen Points.

Introduction

The lecture focuses on the concepts of nationhood, nationalism and the Two-Nation Theory as presented by Allama Muhammad Iqbal, with emphasize on their philosophical and religious

foundations. It examines how Muhammad Iqbal emphasized Islam as a complete way of life and the basis of a distinct Muslim identity. His ideas in the Allahabad Address 1930 will be examined, highlighting his vision for Muslim political autonomy and its role in the creation of Pakistan.

Need: Why did Iqbal deliver Address?

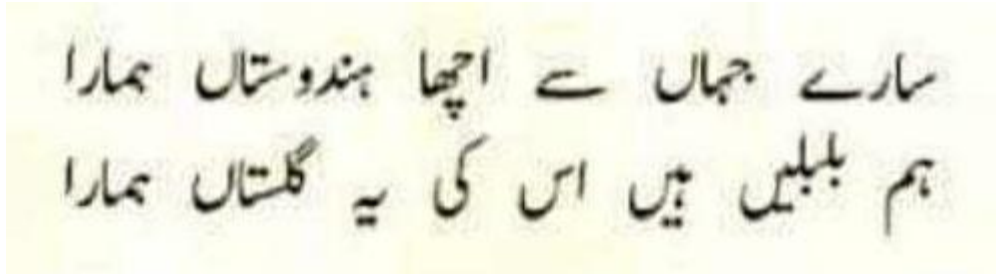
The need for the Allahabad Address arose from the political developments of the late 1920s, when constitutional reforms in British India strengthened majority rule. Although these reforms expanded participation, they created serious concerns among Muslims, especially in minority provinces, where political power depended on numbers. Earlier safeguards proved ineffective, and the failure of the Nehru Report (1928) further increased Muslim insecurity. In this context, Allama Muhammad Iqbal argued that Western-style democracy was unsuitable for India's plural society. Iqbal delivered the address to provide an intellectual and practical solution to these concerns. He emphasized that Muslims were a distinct nation with their own religious, cultural, and social values, and therefore required a separate political arrangement.

Allama Iqbal's Political Career

Allama Muhammad Iqbal poet of the East and philosopher began his political career gradually, moving from an intellectual role to active political engagement in the 1920s. He was elected to the Punjab Legislative Council in 1926, where he gained practical insight into colonial governance and the limitations of representative institutions based on majority rule. During this period, his association with the All-India Muslim League strengthened, particularly after the failure of the Nehru Report (1928) to accommodate Muslim demands. By 1930, Iqbal had emerged as a prominent political thinker and leader, leading to his election as President of the All-India Muslim League session at Allahabad. In 1930, while representing the Muslim League, a famous speech was delivered in Allahabad known as the Allahabad Address.

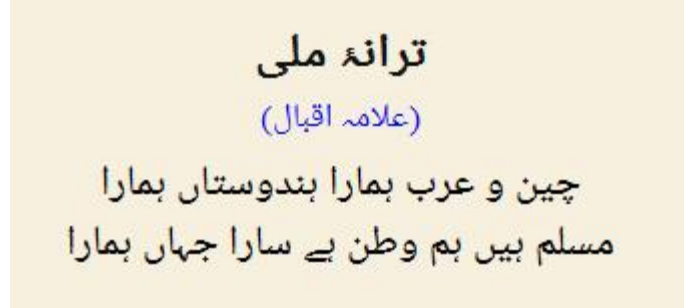
Iqbal Advocacy for Hindu Muslim Unity

In his early intellectual phase, like Sir Syed Ahmad, Iqbal supported the idea of unity among the people of Subcontinent. This is reflected in his famous patriotic poem, published in 1904.



ترانہ ہندی اقبال علامہ —

In this poem, Iqbal expresses love for India as a beautiful land, describing it as a “garden” and its people as “nightingales,” showing unity and harmony among communities at that time. At that time, Iqbal was promoting the idea of national unity and love for the homeland, regardless of religion or background. At this stage, Iqbal viewed Indian society as a shared cultural space. However, this idea of unity was primarily emotional and cultural rather than based on a detailed political analysis.



This poem was written in a time when Hindus and Muslims were being encouraged to unite against British rule. Iqbal’s early poetry reflects a sense of Indian nationalism along with a broader Muslim identity; their identity is global (*Ummah*-based). Over time, Iqbal reconsidered his earlier ideas.

Evolution of Iqbal’s Political Thought

Allama Iqbal’s political thought evolved with time. He went to Europe in **1905** for higher education. He studied in England and Germany, where he developed many of his philosophical

and political ideas. After his visit to Europe, Allama Iqbal's political perspective underwent a significant transformation. He gradually shifted from supporting Indian nationalism to emphasizing a distinct Muslim identity based on religion, culture, and history. Influenced by his observations of European society, he developed a strong critique of Western materialism, highlighting its moral and spiritual shortcomings.

"ابنی ملت پر قیاس اقوامِ مغرب سے نہ کر
خاص بے ترکیب میں قومِ رسولِ ہاشمی"

Iqbal emphasizes that Muslims are a **distinct nation (Millat)**, united by **faith**, which is the core idea of **Muslim nationalism**.

He observed that religious, cultural, and social differences between Hindus and Muslims were too significant to be ignored in political organization. He came to the conclusion that Muslims were not merely a minority but a distinct nation with their own civilization and worldview. This shift marked a turning point in his thought and laid the foundation for Muslim nationalism. This transformation is reflected later in his political vision.

In **1930**, Allama Muhammad Iqbal clearly moved from poetic ideas of Muslim unity to a **practical political vision** in his Allahabad Address. Here, he **identified specific regions** where Muslims could form a separate political unit.

Iqbal's Allahabad Address: Vision for a Separate Muslim State

Allama Muhammad Iqbal presided over the annual session of the All-India Muslim League held at Allahabad in December 1930. In his presidential address, Allama Muhammad Iqbal urged the Muslims of the Subcontinent to demand a separate homeland. This was the first time such a demand was formally articulated. His speech was based on the long-standing concept of the Two-Nation Theory. He found a golden opportunity to present his views when he was elected President of the All-India Muslim League at Allahabad. He truly himself earned the title of 'The Dreamer of Pakistan'.

Crux of Allahabad Address

The crux of the Allahabad Address is the demand for **Muslim political identity, self-governance, and constitutional safeguards within a separate territorial framework**, laying the foundation for the idea of Pakistan. Now we will analyse the Allahabad Address

Analysis of Allahabad Address

Critique of Indian Nationalism

In the Allahabad Address (1930), Allama Muhammad Iqbal critically rejected **Indian Nationalism** by arguing that India was not a single nation but a continent of diverse communities. He opposed the idea of a unified nationalism based on territory, stating that such a system would ignore the distinct identity of Muslims and subject them to majority dominance. At the same time, he strongly highlighted Muslim nationalism, emphasizing that Muslims possessed a unique collective identity rooted in Islam. This is reflected in his words:

“India is a continent of human groups belonging to different races, speaking different languages, and professing different religions. Their behaviour is not at all determined by a common race-consciousness. Even the Hindus do not form a homogeneous group.”

This quotation supports his argument that Indian nationalism was impractical, while reinforcing the idea that Muslims, as a distinct nation, required separate political recognition and autonomy.

Separate Muslim Identity and Muslim Nationhood

Allama Iqbal has deeply studied Islam as a religion and complete code of life. He was thoroughly convinced that both the Hindus and the Muslims were two entirely distinct and separate nations and that they could never be welded into one nation under any system. The concept of *Ummah* plays a central role in this understanding. It refers to the global community of Muslims united by faith and shared moral values. Iqbal further explained that Muslims formed a distinct political community because Islam had shaped their collective life over centuries.

He further emphasized the central role of Islam in shaping Muslim identity, declaring that “It cannot be denied that Islam, regarded as an ethical ideal plus a certain kind of polity—by which

expression I mean a social structure regulated by a legal system and animated by a specific ethical ideal has been the chief formative factor in the life-history of the Muslims of India. It has furnished those basic emotions and loyalties which gradually unify scattered individuals and groups and finally transform them into a well-defined people.”

Muhammad Iqbal, Presidential Address Delivered at the All-India Muslim League Session,
Allahabad, 29 December 1930

He explained:

“Islam is not a church. It is a state conceived as a contractual organism long before Rousseau ever thought of such a thing.”

Muhammad Iqbal, *The Reconstruction of Religious Thought in Islam* (1930)

He further said that “It is not Muslims who have saved Islam; it is Islam that has saved Muslims.” These ideas align with Iqbal’s philosophy in the Allahabad Address 1930, where he emphasized that Islam is not just a religion but a **complete social and political system** shaping Muslim nationhood. It emphasizes that Islam provides a complete framework for both individual and collective life. At the same time, Iqbal advocated for the revival of Islamic political thought, presenting Islam as a complete system of life that integrates religion with governance. This intellectual shift led him to articulate the concept of Muslim nationhood, arguing that Muslims were a separate nation rather than a minority, which later became a foundational idea in the development of the **Two-Nation Theory**. This Address is considered as an authentic document on Islam as a system of life. It gave a new momentum to the struggle of the Muslims for independence.

Iqbal’s Perspective on Two-Nation Theory

The Two-Nation Theory is based on the idea that Hindus and Muslims were two separate nations, each with its own religion, culture, history, and social system. Therefore, they required separate political arrangements. Iqbal’s Address states that “India is a continent of human groups belonging to different races, speaking different languages, and professing different religions. Allama Iqbal challenged the assumption that India was a single nation by asserting that it was a diverse subcontinent composed of multiple communities, each with its own religion, culture,

history, and social system. This statement reinforced the argument of the Two-Nation Theory by highlighting that India lacked the characteristics of a unified nation. Iqbal's concept of the **Two-Nation Theory** is based on the idea that **Muslims and Hindus are two separate nations**, not just religious communities.

Political Safeguards for Muslim

In the Allahabad Address (1930), Allama Muhammad Iqbal initially acknowledged the need for **political safeguards** such as constitutional protections and provincial autonomy to protect Muslim rights within a federal structure of India. He was concerned that a simple majority-based system would not ensure justice for Muslims in the long run. Iqbal moved beyond the idea of temporary safeguards and argued that only **political autonomy in Muslim-majority regions** could permanently secure Muslim identity, rights, and development.

Formation of A North West State and Self-Government Rule

After analyzing political realities, Iqbal presented a practical constitutional solution. He categorically identified those areas where Muslims lived in a majority.

Iqbal stated that "I would like to see the Punjab, North-West Frontier Province, Sind and Baluchistan amalgamated into a single State. Self-government within the British Empire or without the British Empire, the formation of a consolidated North-West Indian Muslim State appears to me to be the final destiny of the Muslims, at least of North-West India." (Iqbal, Presidential Address at the All-India Muslim League Session, Allahabad, 29 December 1930)

This statement from Address presents Iqbal's vision that the Muslim-majority four provinces should be merged into a single political unit. He emphasizes that Muslims of North-West India share a distinct identity based on religion, culture, and history, and therefore require political unity to safeguard their interests. His suggestion of "self-government within or without the British Empire" highlights the central demand for **Muslim autonomy and control over their own political affairs**.

Iqbal also describes the formation of a **consolidated Muslim state** as the "final destiny" of Muslims in North-West India, indicating that this development is both natural and historically

necessary. The idea is deeply rooted in the **Two-Nation Theory**, which holds that Muslims are a separate nation and cannot be effectively represented in a Hindu-majority political system.

This marked the first clear political articulation of Muslim autonomy in territorial terms. It critically examined the application of Western democracy in India and argued that majority rule in a diverse society would lead to domination rather than balanced governance.

Its essence was that “the Muslim demand for the creation of a Muslim India within India is... perfectly justified.”

Thus, this vision laid the **intellectual and ideological foundation for the demand of Pakistan**, marking a turning point in Muslim political thought in South Asia. Iqbal did not propose a state based solely on territory or power. His vision was rooted in ethical and spiritual principles derived from Islam. He emphasized that such a state should allow Muslims to organize their society according to their values while remaining adaptable to changing conditions.

In fact, Allama Iqbal and the Muslim League recognized that Muslim interests could not be adequately protected within a purely majoritarian framework, which contributed to the demand for a separate political arrangement. This reflects that the Muslim state was envisioned by Iqbal as dynamic, progressive, and morally grounded, rather than rigid or purely traditional.

Although Iqbal did not explicitly use the name Pakistan, his ideas laid its intellectual foundation. In 1933, Chaudhry Rehmat Ali introduced the name “Pakistan,” giving a clear identity to the Muslim majority areas which categorically identified by Iqbal. The idea of Pakistan came from Allahabad Address, got further documentary strength Chaudhry Rehmat Ali published a pamphlet “Now and Never” in 1933. In his pamphlet, he further elaborated Allama Muhammad Iqbal’s idea of Pakistan more comprehensively by including Kashmir within the territory of the proposed Muslim state. He also coined the word ‘Pakistan’ from the initial letters of the prospective component units of the future Muslim state. The word Pakistan literally means, ‘The Land of the Pure’.

Iqbal's Address: Reaction of Congress, Muslim League, and British Government

The Allahabad Address of Allama Muhammad Iqbal received mixed reactions from different political groups. The Indian National Congress strongly opposed his ideas, as it believed in a united India and rejected the concept of separate Muslim statehood. Congress leaders viewed Iqbal's proposal as a threat to national unity and feared that it would divide the country on religious lines. The tribune condemned Iqbal for giving the idea of separate state, "Iqbal was solely responsible for the Hindu-Muslim tension." "Iqbal wanted to snatch the country of Hindus from them and to give it to the Muslims." (Hindu Columnist, *Inqilab* Lahore)

On the other hand, the All-India Muslim League gradually appreciated Iqbal's vision, as it addressed Muslim political concerns and identity. Many Muslim leaders saw it as a practical solution for safeguarding their rights. The Daily *Inqilab* and the Daily *Hamdam* Lucknow enthusiastically supported the views of Iqbal. Daily *Inqilab* writes that "the fact is that Iqbal's Address is the first crashing blow to the Hindu concept of 'Nationalism' and their desire to establish Hindu Raj." The British government, however, maintained a cautious and neutral stance; while it did not openly support the idea, it observed these developments carefully as part of its broader colonial policy of managing political differences in Subcontinent.

Iqbal's Correspondence with Jinnah Regarding Muslim Future

The correspondence between Allama Muhammad Iqbal and Muhammad Ali Jinnah mainly took place between **1936 and 1937**. During this period, Iqbal wrote several letters to Jinnah, urging him to lead the Muslim community and work for a separate Muslim state in the Subcontinent.

He wrote to Jinnah:

"A separate federation of Muslim provinces, reformed on the lines I have suggested above, is the only course by which we can secure a peaceful India and save Muslims from the domination of non-Muslims."

Muhammad Iqbal, Letter to Muhammad Ali Jinnah, 21 June 1937 (Letters of Iqbal to Jinnah)

This shows that Iqbal viewed political separation as a practical and constitutional solution, not as

an emotional or sudden demand. At this stage, Iqbal's thought clearly established that Muslims were not merely a minority but a distinct political nation entitled to self-determination.

In another letter, he explained:

“The question therefore is: how is it possible to solve the problem of Muslim India? The only way to do this is to redistribute the country and to provide one or more Muslim states with absolute majorities.”

Muhammad Iqbal, Letter to Muhammad Ali Jinnah, 28 May 1937 (Letters of Iqbal to Jinnah)

This marked a decisive shift from demands for safeguards to the idea of separate political units based on nationhood.

Materialization of Iqbal's Idea into Political Reality

Muslim politics at that stage remained largely confined to constitutional negotiation and the pursuit of safeguards within an all-India framework. Consequently, a clear gap persisted between conceptual clarity and political execution, as the Address had outlined a direction but not yet a mechanism for its realization. This gap began to narrow with the re-emergence of Muhammad Ali Jinnah as a central political authority. Iqbal wrote a series of letters to Jinnah while he was in England, urging him to return and lead the Muslims of India. Possessing both constitutional expertise and organizational discipline, Jinnah reoriented the All-India Muslim League from an elite platform into a representative political force. Jinnah leadership provided coherence, strategy, and continuity, enabling Muslim political thought to move from abstraction to structured mobilization. In this transformation, Jinnah's role was decisive.

Conclusion

In conclusion, the Allahabad Address delivered by Allama Muhammad Iqbal in 1930 holds great historical significance as it provided a clear philosophical and political direction to the Muslims of the Subcontinent. It strengthened the foundation of the Two-Nation Theory by emphasizing that Muslims are a distinct nation with their own religion, culture, and identity, and that Islam is a complete way of life. Iqbal highlighted the limitations of majority rule in a diverse society and

proposed the consolidation of Muslim-majority regions as a practical solution for safeguarding Muslim interests. Finally, the address marked a shift from pan-Islamic ideals to territorial nationalism, recognizing the need for a defined geographical space for Muslims. This vision removed political confusion among Muslims and helped them understand their separate identity and future goals. His ideas were later supported by Muhammad Ali Jinnah and contributed to the formulation of the Lahore Resolution. Ultimately, the Allahabad Address played a decisive role in awakening Muslim consciousness and laid the ideological foundation for the creation of Pakistan.

Lecture 07

Government of India Act 1935 and Formation of Congress Ministries

Mirco Learning Outcomes

By the end of this lecture, students will be able to:

- Identify the key features of the Government of India Act 1935, focusing on provincial autonomy and the federal structure.
- Explain how the 1937 elections reshaped political power between Congress and the Muslim League.
- Analyze how Congress ministries (1937–1939) influenced Muslim political identity.

Government of India Act 1935

The earlier constitutional developments in the subcontinent that paved the way for the Government of India Act 1935, focusing specifically on provincial autonomy and the proposed federal structure, and how these provisions contributed to the consolidation of separate electorates and ultimately the emergence of separate states in the subcontinent, were the following.

The Indian Councils Act 1909 aimed to ease rising nationalist pressure and secure Muslim political support; the Government of India Act 1919 followed World War I to address growing demands for self-government through limited power-sharing; and the Simon Commission 1927 was appointed due to dissatisfaction with the 1919 system and the need for further reform. Consequently, the Government of India Act 1935 was introduced to establish a more comprehensive constitutional framework, address political unrest, and grant provincial autonomy.

The Important features of Govt of India Act 1935 are:

- **Federal System (Proposed):** Proposed an all-India federation including British India and princely states, though it was not implemented.

- **Provincial Autonomy:** Abolished dyarchy in provinces and granted them full autonomy with responsible governments.
- **Dyarchy at Centre:** Introduced dyarchy at the central level by dividing subjects into reserved and transferred categories.
- **Bicameral Legislature:** Established a two-house federal legislature consisting of the Council of State and Federal Assembly.
- **Expanded Franchise:** Extended voting rights to about 10–14% of the population based on property and education qualifications.
- **Separate Electorates:** Continued and expanded separate electorates for religious and minority groups.
- **Governor-General Powers:** Retained extensive powers, including veto authority and control over defense and foreign affairs.
- **Governors' Powers:** Provincial governors had special powers to override ministries and safeguard British interests.
- **Federal Court (1937):** Established a Federal Court to interpret constitutional matters and resolve disputes.
- **Division of Powers:** Introduced three legislative lists, Federal, Provincial, and Concurrent, to distribute authority.
- **Safeguards for British Control:** Key areas like defence, finance, and external affairs remained under British control.
- **Provincial Elections 1937:** Implemented provincial autonomy through elections, leading to the formation of ministries in provinces.

Provincial autonomy became a major feature of the Act. Provinces could now form elected governments. Political parties formed ministries after winning elections. These ministries became responsible for provincial administration. This reform increased Indian participation in governance.

Before this reform, provinces followed the dyarchy system. Dyarchy was introduced by the Government of India Act, 1919. Administrative powers were divided between two authorities. Indian ministers managed to transfer subjects. British officials managed reserved subjects.

Transferred subjects included education and agriculture. Reserved subjects included finance, police, and law and order. Because of this division, Indian ministers had limited authority. Many political leaders criticized the dyarchy system. They demanded greater provincial power.

The Government of India Act, 1935, abolished dyarchy in the provinces. Provincial legislatures gained greater authority over administration. The majority parties formed ministries after the elections. These ministry-controlled departments include health and agriculture. Provincial governments became more active in governance.

However, British authority remained important. The British Crown appointed the provincial governor. The governor retained special constitutional powers. He could intervene in administrative matters when necessary. These powers applied to law-and-order issues.

Provincial autonomy, therefore, expanded political participation. However, British oversight remained within the constitutional structure.

An important feature of the Act was the All-India Federation. A federation divides authority between central and regional governments. The Act proposed a federal political system for India. It aimed to unite British provinces and princely states. This structure attempted to balance national and regional governance.

The colonial administration directly governed British provinces. Hereditary rulers ruled princely states. However, they remained under British supervision. The Act divided legislative authority into three lists. These lists define the powers of each level of government.

The Federal List covered national matters such as defense. The Provincial List covered local administrative subjects. The Concurrent List allowed both the central and state governments to legislate. Central law prevailed in the event of a conflict. This arrangement attempted to balance authority.

However, the federal system never became operational. Many princely states refused to join the federation. They feared losing political authority. Without their participation, the federation could not begin. The federal provisions, therefore, remained theoretical. Although the federation failed, provincial reforms still operated. These reforms shaped the political environment of the late 1930s.

The Elections of 1937

The Government of India Act 1935 introduced provincial autonomy. This reform created elected provincial governments. The new system required provincial elections to form ministries. Therefore, the British government organized elections in 1937. These elections became the first test of the new constitutional system.

Political Party	Key Leaders	Main Focus	Major Demands / Policies/Manifestos	Nature of Politics
Indian National Congress	Jawaharlal Nehru, Vallabhbhai Patel, C. Rajagopalachari	Nationalism	Complete independence (Swaraj), civil liberties, expansion of education, reduction of land revenue, and economic reforms	All-India, broad-based
All-India Muslim League	Muhammad Ali Jinnah, Liaquat Ali Khan	Muslim political rights	Separate electorates, safeguards for Muslims, fair representation in jobs and legislatures, protection of religion and culture	Minority-focused, constitutional
Unionist Party (Punjab)	Sir Sikandar Hayat Khan	Agrarian stability	Protection of farmers, rural development, and cooperation between communities	Regional, economic
Krishak Praja Party (Bengal)	A. K. Fazlul Huq	Peasant welfare	Land reforms, rights of tenants, and reduction of landlord control	Regional, agrarian

Table: 7.1 Manifesto of Political Parties in the 1937 Elections

Political parties now had to compete in elections. They organized campaigns across different provinces. Candidates were nominated for many constituencies. Voters participated in the electoral process. These activities tested the practical operation of constitutional reforms.

Two major political parties emerged as dominant forces in these elections: the Indian National Congress and the All-India Muslim League. The Congress claimed to represent all Indians, while the Muslim League positioned itself as the representative of Muslim political interests

The Indian National Congress – Manifesto

- Complete Independence (Swaraj) from British rule
- Civil liberties (freedom of speech, press, and association)
- Expansion of education across India
- Reduction of land revenue to ease burden on peasants
- Economic reforms for national development

The All-India Muslim League – Manifesto

- Separate electorates for Muslims
- Safeguards for Muslim political rights
- Fair representation in government jobs and legislatures
- Protection of religion, culture, and identity

These elections, therefore, became politically significant. They revealed the strength of different political organizations. The results also shaped future political strategies. Provincial governments now depend on electoral outcomes. This situation changed the nature of colonial politics.

The electoral system created by the Act determined how elections were organized. Understanding this structure helps explain the election results.

The Result of Elections of 1937

Province	Total Seats	Congress Seats	Muslim League Seats	Government Formed By
Madras	215	159	0	Congress
Bombay	175	86	18	Congress
United Provinces (U.P.)	228	133	29	Congress
Central Provinces	112	71	0	Congress
Bihar	152	98	0	Congress
Orissa	60	36	0	Congress
NWFP	50	19	0	Congress (Allies)
Bengal	250	54	39	Krishak Praja Party (Coalition)
Punjab	175	18	2	Unionist Party
Sindh	60	8	0	Coalition
Assam	108	38	9	Congress (later)

Table 7.2: 1937 Elections Results

The 1937 elections were held in eleven provinces of British India, including Punjab, Bengal, Bombay, Madras, the United Provinces, Bihar, Assam, Sindh, Orissa, and the North-West Frontier Province. Around 30 million people were eligible to vote, but participation remained limited due to property and education qualifications. A total of 1,585 legislative seats were contested, including 482 reserved for Muslims under the system of separate electorates to ensure minority representation.

Performance of the Indian National Congress

The Indian National Congress performed strongly in the elections. It contested elections in most provinces. Congress organized extensive political campaigns. Its leaders mobilized voters across different regions. The party, therefore, gained significant electoral support.

Congress won approximately 716 seats in the legislature. This made it the largest political party. It secured clear majorities in several provinces. These provinces included Madras, the United Provinces, Bihar, Central Provinces, and Orissa. Congress later formed ministries in these regions.

Important provincial leaders headed these ministries. C. Rajagopalachari led the government in Madras. Govind Ballabh Pant headed the ministry in the United Provinces. Sri Krishna Sinha became the Premier of Bihar. B. G. Kher led the ministry in Bombay.

Analysis of Elections 1937

The elections of 1937, held under the Government of India Act 1935, marked a turning point in British Indian politics by introducing provincial autonomy. The Indian National Congress emerged as the dominant party, winning about 716 out of 1,585 seats and forming ministries in six provinces (later seven with NWFP). However, it remained weak in Muslim-majority provinces such as Punjab and Bengal, where regional parties dominated. In contrast, the All-India Muslim League secured only about 109 seats, revealing its limited organizational strength and weak mass support.

These results exposed the weaknesses of the Muslim League and highlighted Congress dominance, leading to the practical application of majority rule. Congress's refusal to form coalition governments with the League deepened political divisions and restricted Muslim participation in governance. This experience increased mistrust and pushed Muslim leadership, under Muhammad Ali Jinnah, to reorganize the League through membership expansion and political mobilization.

The 1937 elections established Congress dominance but also triggered Muslim political consolidation, laying the foundation for the League's emergence as the representative voice of Muslims.

Performance of the All-India Muslim League

The All-India Muslim League performed poorly in the 1937 provincial elections conducted under the Government of India Act 1935, exposing its limited political reach and organizational weakness at the time. Despite claiming to represent Muslim interests, the League secured only about 109 out of 482 Muslim-reserved seats and failed to win a majority in any Muslim-majority province, including Punjab, Bengal, Sindh, and NWFP.

In Punjab, it was decisively overshadowed by the Unionist Party, while in Bengal it faced strong competition from the Krishak Praja Party. Many Muslim voters preferred these regional parties, which had stronger local roots and greater influence.

This performance was particularly disappointing, as the League was unable to form governments or exert meaningful influence in provincial politics. Even in the United Provinces, where it performed relatively better, it was denied power-sharing by the Congress, further highlighting its marginal political position. The results revealed deep structural weaknesses, including its elite-centered leadership, weak grassroots organization, and limited appeal among rural Muslim populations.

However, under the leadership of Muhammad Ali Jinnah, this electoral failure became a strategic turning point. The League undertook significant reorganization, broadened its mass base, and gradually transformed into a dominant political force, ultimately paving the way for the demand for a separate Muslim state in the subcontinent.

Formation of Congress Ministries (1937–1939)

Following the 1937 elections, the Indian National Congress formed ministries in six provinces Madras, Bombay, United Provinces, Bihar, Central Provinces, and Orissa and later extended its influence to a seventh province, the North-West Frontier Province (NWFP), through political alliances. This development marked the first practical implementation of provincial autonomy under the Government of India Act 1935. Although Congress initially hesitated due to the discretionary powers retained by provincial governors, it eventually agreed to assume office after receiving assurances. The formation of these ministries allowed Congress to translate its electoral success into administrative authority, establishing itself as the dominant political force in British India.

Refusal to Form Coalition with the Muslim League

Despite having opportunities for inclusive governance, particularly in provinces like the United Provinces where Muslim League support could have enabled coalition arrangements, Congress largely refused to share power. It conditioned any cooperation on the Muslim League abandoning its separate political identity and merging with Congress. This position was rejected by Muslim League leadership, as it undermined their role as representatives of Muslim political interests. Consequently, Muslims were excluded from meaningful participation in provincial governments, which intensified feelings of political insecurity and reinforced concerns about majority domination.

Exercise of Majority Rule

With clear electoral majorities in several provinces, Congress ministries governed on the principle of majority rule. This was the first significant experience of such governance in British India, where elected representatives exercised authority without substantial power-sharing with minority groups. While Congress leadership presented this as democratic and responsible governance, many Muslims perceived it as majoritarian rule that did not adequately protect minority rights. This experience contributed to a growing realization among Muslim leaders that constitutional safeguards were essential to prevent political marginalization.

Control over Key Departments

Congress ministries exercised control over major administrative departments, including education, agriculture, public health, and local government. Through these departments, they implemented policies that shaped the social, economic, and cultural landscape of the provinces. Educational reforms, language policies, and administrative decisions reflected Congress priorities and ideology. However, in the absence of adequate Muslim representation, many of these policies were viewed with suspicion by Muslim communities, who feared that their cultural identity and socio-economic interests were not being adequately safeguarded.

Overall, the formation and functioning of Congress ministries between 1937 and 1939 not only demonstrated the working of provincial autonomy but also exposed the limitations of majoritarian governance in a diverse society. These developments played a crucial role in

shaping Muslim political consciousness and strengthened the demand for constitutional protections and a distinct political identity.

Atrocities Committed by Indian National Congress against Muslims

During the Congress ministries (1937–1939), Muslim political concerns grew, gradually strengthening support for the All-India Muslim League. These concerns emerged across political, administrative, economic, cultural, and religious spheres and were widely discussed in contemporary reports.

A major issue was the limitation of the Government of India Act 1935. Although it introduced provincial autonomy, it failed to provide strong safeguards for minorities. This created fear among Muslims that majority rule could reduce their political influence. The situation became more serious after the 1937 elections, when Congress formed governments in several provinces and excluded the Muslim League in key areas such as the United Provinces, creating a clear sense of political marginalization.

During the period of Congress ministries (1937–1939), several developments were perceived by Muslims as discriminatory, contributing to a growing sense of political, economic, cultural, and religious marginalization.

Political Exclusion of the Muslims

Muslims were politically marginalized during the Congress ministries as the Indian National Congress refused to form coalition governments with the All-India Muslim League unless it abandoned its separate identity. This exclusion weakened Muslim representation and limited their role in provincial governance.

Administrative Issues

Muslims faced administrative biases in governance structures, where decision-making processes often did not reflect their interests. This created a perception of unequal treatment within provincial administrations.

Economic Exploitation of Muslims

Economic policies, including agrarian reforms such as tenancy laws, were viewed by many Muslims particularly landlords as detrimental to their economic position, leading to a sense of economic insecurity.

Underrepresentation in Jobs

Muslims remained underrepresented in government services and public sector employment. Reports such as the Pirpur and Sharif Reports highlighted these disparities, reinforcing concerns about limited access to state opportunities.

Cultural Alienation

The promotion of Hindi and Congress-oriented cultural symbols in public institutions contributed to a sense of cultural dominance. Muslims felt increasingly alienated from the emerging national identity.

Educational Marginalization

Educational reforms, particularly the Wardha Scheme, were criticized for not accommodating Muslim cultural and religious values. The emphasis on Hindi over Urdu further deepened concerns regarding identity and representation.

Religious Domination

Policies and practices such as the promotion of Vande Mataram, along with reported restrictions on Azan and Juma prayers in some areas, were perceived as interference in religious practices, raising concerns about religious freedom.

These concerns were documented in the Pirpur Report (1938), the Sharif Report (1939), and the observations of A. K. Fazlul Huq.

These developments created a strong sense of insecurity among Muslims, leading to greater unity and increased support for the Muslim League. Under the leadership of Muhammad Ali Jinnah, the League emerged as the main representative of Muslim interests, preparing the ground for future political demands, including the idea of a separate state.

Reorganization of the All India Muslim League

Leadership Role of Muhammad Ali Jinnah

The experience of Congress ministries (1937–1939) strengthened the political leadership of Muhammad Ali Jinnah. He recognized that majority rule under Congress could undermine Muslim interests and therefore emphasized constitutional safeguards and effective representation. Through clear political direction and strategic leadership, Jinnah unified Muslim opinion and re-positioned the All-India Muslim League as a credible political force.

Membership Expansion

After the 1937 elections exposed the organizational weaknesses of the Muslim League, Jinnah initiated large-scale membership campaigns across different provinces. These efforts expanded the party's base, strengthened its organizational structure, and increased political participation among Muslims. As a result, the League became more active, disciplined, and capable of mobilizing public support.

Emergence of All-India Muslim League as Sole Representative of Muslims

The resignation of Congress ministries in 1939 created political space that the Muslim League effectively utilized. Under Jinnah's leadership, the League transformed into a broad-based representative platform. The observance of the Day of Deliverance further consolidated Muslim political sentiment. Consequently, the Muslim League emerged as the principal and widely recognized political voice of Muslims, marking a significant shift toward political unity and laying the foundation for a coherent constitutional strategy.

Conclusion

The formation of congress ministries under 1935 India act failed to address the concerns of Indian Muslims and atrocities committed by the congress, strengthened Muslims resolve for the attainment of a separate homeland. We analyzed the 1937 elections and the formation of Congress ministries, which generated political, cultural, and administrative grievances among Muslims. These developments, in turn, strengthened Muslim political identity and led to the reorganization of the Muslim League under Muhammad Ali Jinnah. As a result, the League emerged as the principal representative of Muslims, laying the foundation for future political developments, including the demand for a separate homeland.

Lecture 08

Lahore Resolution (1940) and Role of Muhammad Ali Jinnah

Micro Learning Outcomes

By the end of this lecture, students will be able to:

- Describe the background of the Lahore Resolution (1940).
- Explain the features of the Lahore Resolution (1940).
- Analyze the role of Muhammad Ali Jinnah in the Lahore Resolution (1940).

Introduction

The Lahore Resolution marked a turning point in Muslim political history. It demanded independent states for Muslims in majority areas, shifting the focus from safeguards to a separate homeland. This resolution united Muslims under a clear objective and strengthened their political position. Jinnah's leadership provided direction and constitutional clarity, laying the foundation for the creation of Pakistan.

Need for Lahore Resolution

After the elections of 1937, the political situation in British India changed significantly. The Indian National Congress formed governments in several provinces and gained strong political control. Muslims, represented by the All-India Muslim League, did not achieve similar success in these elections. This created a sense of political imbalance and uncertainty among Muslims.

The Congress ministries introduced policies that were viewed by Muslims as biased. Issues such as the promotion of Hindi, Bande Mataram in schools, and lack of Muslim representation increased tensions. Many Muslims felt that their religious and cultural identity was being ignored. These grievances led to distrust between Muslims and Congress leadership.

The Government of India Act 1935 also failed to satisfy Muslim demands. Although it provided provincial autonomy, it did not ensure effective safeguards for Muslim rights. Muslims feared that in a democratic system dominated by the Hindu majority, they would always remain politically weak.

At the same time, Muslim identity was becoming stronger. Leaders emphasized that Muslims were not just a minority but a separate nation with their own religion, culture, and traditions. There was a growing fear that without a separate homeland, Muslims would lose their identity and political voice.

As a result, Muslim leadership shifted from demanding minority rights to demanding a separate homeland. This marked a major change in political thinking and strategy.

These conditions led to a historic gathering where Muslims formally expressed their demands.

Lahore Resolution 1940

Session, Timeline & Participants

The Lahore Session was the 27th annual session of the All-India Muslim League, held at Minto Park, Lahore, from 22 to 24 March 1940. It was a landmark gathering in which Muslim political leadership came together to define the future direction of Muslim politics in British India. This was not a limited or regional meeting. Muslim leaders, delegates, and supporters came from different provinces of the subcontinent, including Punjab, Bengal, Sindh, the North-West Frontier Province (NWFP), the United Provinces (UP), Kashmir, and Balochistan. This wide participation reflected the collective concerns of Muslims across India.

The session was presided over by Muhammad Ali Jinnah, who was the President of the Muslim League. The resolution was formally moved by A. K. Fazlul Huq, the Premier of Bengal. It was supported by leaders from different regions, including Chaudhry Khaliquzzaman, Sardar Aurangzeb Khan, Sir Abdullah Haroon of Sindh, Qazi Muhammad Essa of Balochistan, and Pir Ziauddin Andrabi of Kashmir. Senior League figures such as Liaquat Ali Khan, Sir Sikandar Hayat Khan, and Khawaja Nazimuddin were also associated with the League leadership during this session.

On 22 and 23 March, detailed discussions were held on the political situation of Muslims and the failure of earlier constitutional arrangements. Leaders highlighted Muslim grievances and emphasized the need for a clear political solution. On 23 March, Jinnah delivered his historic address, explaining that Muslims were a separate nation with distinct identity, culture, and political interests. His speech provided direction and strengthened the demand for a separate homeland.

On 24 March 1940, the Lahore Resolution was adopted by the Muslim League. This marked a decisive step toward the demand for independent Muslim states. The session demonstrated that this demand represented the collective will of Muslims across the subcontinent.

The significance of this session becomes clearer when we examine the actual wording of the resolution.

Original Text of Lahore Resolution

The Lahore Resolution, adopted on 24 March 1940 at the 27th annual session of the All-India Muslim League, stated:

“Resolved that it is the considered view of this session of the All-India Muslim League that no constitutional plan would be workable in this country or acceptable to the Muslims unless it is designed on the following basic principle, namely, that geographically contiguous units are demarcated into regions which should be so constituted, with such territorial readjustments as may be necessary, that the areas in which the Muslims are numerically in a majority as in the north-western and eastern zones of India should be grouped to constitute independent states in which the constituent units shall be autonomous and sovereign. That adequate, effective and mandatory safeguards shall be specifically provided in the constitution for minorities in these units and in the regions for the protection of their religious, cultural, economic, political, administrative and other rights and interests in consultation with them.”

This text clearly shows that Muslims demanded “independent states” where they could govern themselves. It emphasized autonomy and sovereignty, meaning full political control without domination by others. Although the word “Pakistan” was not used, the idea of a separate homeland was clearly presented.

The resolution also highlighted “Muslim majority areas,” such as Punjab, Bengal, Sindh, and NWFP, as the basis for these states. At the same time, it ensured safeguards for minorities, reflecting a commitment to fairness and protection of all communities.

From this text, we can clearly identify the main objectives of the resolution.

Objectives of Lahore Resolution

the Lahore Resolution was the demand for independent Muslim states in the subcontinent. The Muslim League clearly stated that Muslims should have their own separate political units in areas where they were in a majority. This demand was based on the belief that Muslims could not secure their rights in a united India dominated by the Hindu majority. Therefore, a separate homeland was seen as necessary for their political survival.

Another important objective was to ensure political autonomy and sovereignty for Muslims. The resolution emphasized that the proposed states would be autonomous and sovereign, meaning they would have full authority over their internal and external affairs. This would allow Muslims to make decisions according to their own political and social values. It aimed to establish a system where Muslims could govern themselves independently.

The resolution also aimed at the recognition of Muslims as a separate nation. It rejected the idea that Muslims were merely a minority in India. Instead, it declared that Muslims had their own distinct identity based on religion, culture, and history. This recognition strengthened the Two-Nation Theory and gave legitimacy to the demand for a separate state.

Another objective was the protection of Muslim cultural, religious, and economic interests. The resolution aimed to safeguard Islamic traditions, language, and way of life. At the same time, it included provisions to ensure justice and protection for minorities living in Muslim-majority areas. This reflected a balanced approach toward governance and social harmony.

These objectives are further reflected in the key features of the resolution.

Features of Lahore Resolution

The Lahore Resolution was the clear concept of a separate homeland for Muslims. It rejected the earlier demand of safeguards within a united India and instead presented Muslims as a distinct

nation. This was closely linked with the Two-Nation Theory, which argued that Muslims and Hindus were two separate nations with different religions, cultures, and social systems. This ideological shift gave a strong and permanent basis to the demand for Pakistan and the demand for independent and autonomous units. The resolution proposed that Muslim-majority regions should be grouped into “independent states,” where constituent units would be autonomous and sovereign. This meant full control over governance, laws, and administration. It also showed that Muslims wanted a constitutional and structured political solution rather than temporary arrangements.

The term “independent states” reflected flexibility in the demand. At that stage, it did not clearly define a single centralized state but allowed the possibility of more than one Muslim state. However, the underlying idea remained clear: Muslims must have political independence and self-rule. This flexibility helped unite leaders from different regions with varying political interests.

The resolution also emphasized “Muslim majority areas,” including Punjab, Bengal, Sindh, and NWFP, as the territorial basis of the proposed states. At the same time, it included a strong clause about safeguards for minorities. It ensured that non-Muslims living in these areas would have protection of their religious, cultural, and economic rights. This reflected a balanced and inclusive approach.

Another important feature was the constitutional and legal nature of the demand. The resolution was not emotional or revolutionary in tone but presented through formal political language. It aimed to achieve its goals through negotiations and legal processes.

The resolution demonstrated the unity of Muslim political voice. It was adopted unanimously by the Muslim League, showing agreement among leaders from different provinces. This unity strengthened the League’s position as the sole representative of Muslims.

Role of Muhammad Ali Jinnah

Muhammad Ali Jinnah played a decisive role in shaping the Lahore Resolution and defending the Two-Nation Theory. By 1940, after decades of political experience (joining the Muslim League in 1913 and reorganizing it after 1934), he had concluded that Muslims were a separate

nation. His leadership transformed the Muslim League into a united and disciplined political force representing Muslims across India.

During the Lahore Session, Jinnah delivered his historic presidential address on 23 March 1940, in which he logically defended the Two-Nation Theory. His speech is considered one of the most important political statements in South Asian history.

“The Hindus and the Muslims belong to two different religious philosophies, social customs and literatures. They neither intermarry nor interdine together and, indeed, they belong to two different civilizations which are based mainly on conflicting ideas and conceptions. Their aspects on life and of life are different. It is quite clear that Hindus and Muslims derive their inspiration from different sources of history. They have different epics, different heroes, and different episodes. Very often the hero of one is a foe of the other and, likewise, their victories and defeats overlap.

To yoke together two such nations under a single state, one as a numerical minority and the other as a majority, must lead to growing discontent and the final destruction of any fabric that may be so built for the government of such a state.

Muslims are a nation according to any definition of a nation, and they must have their homelands, their territory and their state. We wish to live in peace and harmony with our neighbors as a free and independent people.”

In this address, Jinnah used logical arguments based on religion, history, culture, and politics to prove that Hindus and Muslims were two separate nations. He rejected the idea of a united India and showed that majority rule would lead to Muslim political weakness. His reasoning transformed the Two-Nation Theory into a practical political demand.

Jinnah also ensured the passage of the Lahore Resolution moved by A. K. Fazlul Huq and guided the Muslim League with unity and discipline. His leadership turned a theoretical idea into a powerful movement for Pakistan.

Despite strong leadership, the resolution faced different reactions from various groups.

Reactions to Lahore Resolution

The Lahore Resolution was strongly rejected by the Indian National Congress, which considered it a threat to Indian unity. Congress leaders argued that India was a single nation and that partition on religious lines was unacceptable. The Hindu press reacted sharply and often critically. Several newspapers mocked the resolution and questioned its practicality. Notably, newspapers such as The Hindustan Times referred to it as the “Pakistan Resolution” in their editorials, even though the word “Pakistan” was not used in the original text. Some editorials also described it as “Jinnah’s Pakistan scheme” or “Jinnah ka Pakistan,” presenting it as a divisive political demand. This labeling, although intended as criticism, later popularized the term “Pakistan.”

It is important to understand that the Lahore Session was not a continuous procession but a structured political gathering consisting of meetings, speeches, and formal deliberations. While a large number of people attended, the resolution was debated and passed by elected representatives of the Muslim League. Critics from Congress and sections of the Hindu press tried to minimize its importance by portraying it as a limited or symbolic gathering. However, the participation of leaders from multiple provinces gave it national significance.

The British government adopted a cautious and strategic response. They neither accepted nor rejected the Lahore Resolution immediately. Instead, they observed the growing strength of the Muslim League and recognized it as a major political force. The British used this development to balance Congress and the Muslim League, keeping both engaged in negotiations. Their policy of delay allowed them to maintain control while the political situation evolved.

Among Muslims, the resolution received widespread support and enthusiasm. It provided a clear political objective and strengthened unity across different regions. Public meetings and discussions were held to explain its significance. Many Muslims viewed it as a practical solution to their political and cultural concerns. This support transformed the Muslim League into a mass political movement.

At the same time, Hindus living in Muslim-majority areas expressed concerns about their future. They feared loss of political influence and uncertainty regarding minority rights. These concerns increased communal tensions and led to further debate on the issue of safeguards.

These reactions highlight the broader importance of the resolution in shaping future politics.

Impact of Lahore Resolution

The Lahore Resolution brought a major political transformation among Muslims of the subcontinent. It shifted Muslim politics from demanding minority safeguards to demanding complete independence. After 1940, the All-India Muslim League emerged as the sole spokesperson of Muslims. The Lahore Resolution, which was later clearly interpreted as the demand for Pakistan in the Delhi session of 1946, became popularly known as the Pakistan Resolution. This gave Muslims a clear political direction and unified them under one objective. The authority and influence of the Muslim League increased significantly after this development, especially in elections and negotiations.

Another important impact was the rise in communal polarization between Hindus and Muslims. The demand for separate states created a clear division in political thinking. Congress strongly opposed the idea, while Muslims increasingly supported it. This widened the political gap and reduced chances of Hindu-Muslim cooperation. Communal tensions increased, and both sides began to prepare for separate political futures. As a result, the idea of a united India became increasingly unrealistic.

The Lahore Resolution also had a deep impact on political developments between 1940 and 1947. It became the foundation for all future constitutional negotiations. Proposals such as the Cripps Mission (1942), the Wavell Plan (1945), and the Cabinet Mission Plan (1946) reflected the growing importance of Muslim demands. The Muslim League used the resolution as a clear policy framework in discussions with the British and Congress. Ultimately, it directly contributed to the partition of India and the establishment of Pakistan in 1947.

Another significant impact was mass mobilization and identity formation among Muslims. The resolution created strong political awareness among ordinary Muslims in both urban and rural areas. Public meetings, newspapers, and political campaigns helped spread its message across the subcontinent. Muslims increasingly identified themselves as part of a separate nation with a shared destiny. This strengthened support for the Pakistan Movement at the grassroots level.

Finally, the Lahore Resolution also had an international and constitutional impact. It brought the Muslim question to global attention, especially during and after World War II. It forced the British government to recognize the Muslim League as a key stakeholder in India's future. The

resolution also introduced a clear constitutional alternative to a unitary Indian system, making partition a practical political solution.

Conclusion

The Lahore Resolution of 1940 stands as a historic turning point in the political struggle of Muslims in the subcontinent. It marked a clear shift from demanding minority safeguards within a united India to demanding independent Muslim states. This resolution provided a definite direction to Muslim politics and united them under a single objective. It also laid the ideological and constitutional foundation for the future state of Pakistan. By presenting a clear demand, the resolution transformed the Muslim League into a strong and organized political force.

The leadership of Muhammad Ali Jinnah was central to the success of this resolution. His vision, determination, and constitutional approach guided Muslims toward a realistic political solution. He successfully united Muslims from different regions and backgrounds under one platform. Through his logical arguments and clear leadership, he strengthened the demand for a separate homeland. His role in the Lahore Resolution firmly established him as the undisputed leader of the Pakistan Movement.

The Lahore Resolution directly contributed to the creation of Pakistan in 1947. It became the basis of all major political developments between 1940 and independence. The demand presented in Lahore gradually gained strength through negotiations, political efforts, and public support. Over time, this vision was achieved with the establishment of Pakistan as an independent state. Thus, the resolution served as the foundation for the emergence of a new nation. This event also provides important lessons for future generations. It highlights the importance of unity, strong leadership, and political awareness in achieving national goals. It shows that a clear vision, combined with collective effort and determination, can bring significant historical change.

Lecture 09

Final Phase of Pakistan Movement (1940–1947)

Micro Learning Outcomes

By the end of this lecture, students will be able to:

- Identify the key political developments between 1940 and 1946, including the Cripps Mission, Quit India Movement, Simla Conference, and the Elections of 1945–46.
- Explain the causes and significance of these events in shaping political relations between the All-India Muslim League and the Indian National Congress.
- Analyze how political negotiations, constitutional proposals, and electoral outcomes that shaped the demand for Pakistan and led to the partition of Subcontinent.

Introduction

The period from 1940 to 1947 represents the final and most decisive phase of the Pakistan Movement, during which the Muslims of the Subcontinent transformed their demand for a separate homeland into a political reality. This struggle was firmly based on the Two Nations Theory, which emphasized that Muslims and Hindus were two distinct nations with different religions, cultures, traditions, and social systems. Muslims feared that in a united India, their religious, political, and economic rights would not be protected. Under the dynamic leadership of Quaid-i-Azam Muhammad Ali Jinnah, Muslims united on a single platform and strengthened the role of the All-India Muslim League as the true representative of Muslim political aspirations.

The Lahore Resolution, passed on 23 March 1940 marked the decisive turning point in the Pakistan Movement. It declared that Muslims were not merely a minority but a separate nation and demanded that Muslim-majority regions in the northwest and northeast of India be constituted as independent states. This resolution made it clear to the British government that any future constitutional settlement in India could not be achieved without addressing Muslim political demands.

On the other hands, the outbreak of World War II made Britain dependent on India's support, but Congress's 1939 resignation and the Muslim League's demand for separate states created

a political deadlock. To end this political deadlock The British government sent different mission and gave different proposal to Indians. One of them was the Cripps Mission.

Cripps Mission (1942)

The Cripps Mission (March 1942) was sent to India by the British government to secure full Indian cooperation for the World War II effort. as Japanese forces advanced in Southeast Asia. So, the Britain needed strong political support from Indian leaders because India was one of its most important colonies. However, political tensions between the British government, the Indian National Congress, and the All-India Muslim League were already very high. The British wanted cooperation in the war, but Indian political parties wanted constitutional reforms and a clear promise of independence.

To resolve this crisis, the British government sent Sir Stafford Cripps to India in March 1942. His mission was to present a new constitutional proposal and convince Indian leaders to support the war effort. so, let's talk about the main proposal.

Main Proposals of the Cripps Mission

The Cripps proposals included several important points:

- After the war, India would be granted Dominion Status, meaning it would have self government within the British Commonwealth.
- A new constitution would be prepared by Indian representatives.
- Most importantly, provinces would have the right to opt out of the future Indian union if they did not agree with the constitution.

This last point was very significant for Muslim politics. As Muslim League saw it as an indirect recognition that Muslim-majority areas could form a separate political arrangement in the future. Historians often say that this clause strengthened the League's argument that Muslims were a separate political nation.

However, the Cripps Mission failed because different political groups reacted differently to the proposals.

The Indian National Congress rejected the plan because it did not offer immediate independence and allowed the possibility of India's division.

The All-India Muslim League (AIML) rejected the Cripps Mission proposals of 1942 primarily because the plan did not openly promise the creation of a separate state of Pakistan. While the proposal offered an indirect possibility of separation for provinces, it was not the solid, obvious commitment to Pakistan that Muhammad Ali Jinnah demanded.

Why Did Mission Fail?

The Cripps Mission of 1942 failed because its proposals did not satisfy either major political group in India. The Indian National Congress rejected the plan since it allowed provinces the option to opt out of a future union, which Congress saw as a threat to India's unity. The Muslim League, on the other hand, rejected it because it did not fully guarantee the creation of separate Muslim states.

This failure furthered Indian frustration with British rule, showing that Britain was unwilling to immediately grant meaningful independence despite India's contributions to the war effort. In response, the Congress decided that direct action was necessary, leading to the launch of the Quit India Movement in August 1942. The movement demanded the immediate withdrawal of the British from India and mobilized mass civil disobedience, strikes, and protests across the country, marking a decisive phase in India's freedom struggle.

Quit India Movement (1942)

The Quit India Movement, launched in August 1942, was a decisive mass movement demanding the immediate withdrawal of the British from India. It was led by the Indian National Congress under the leadership of Mahatma Gandhi, who called for "Do or Die" as the guiding principle of civil disobedience. The movement emerged as a direct response to the failure of the Cripps Mission, which had promised postwar dominion status but failed to grant immediate independence or satisfy Indian leaders.

British Reaction and Suppression

The British government reacted very quickly against it. Within days, many Congress leaders, including Gandhi and Jawaharlal Nehru, were arrested. Political gatherings were banned, and strict laws were imposed to stop protests. Because of this repression, the movement lost much of its leadership, although protests continued in different parts of India.

Position of the All India Muslim League

The All-India Muslim League did not support the Quit India Movement. Because, Quaid-i-Azam Muhammad Ali Jinnah believed that immediate independence without constitutional safeguards would create a Hindu-majority government that might ignore Muslim interests.

Instead of joining Congress protests, the Muslim League continued its political work and focused on strengthening the demand for Pakistan. Moreover, the talks between Muhammad Ali Jinnah and Mahatma Gandhi in 1944 aimed to resolve differences over India's future. Gandhi supported the idea of united India, while Jinnah strongly demanded a separate Muslim state (Pakistan). The talks end too without any result.

Simla Conference (1945)

The British arranged the Simla Conference in 1945 mainly to resolve the growing political deadlock in India and to prepare for a future transfer of power. The Simla Conference is also known as 'Wavell Plan' because it was proposed by the British Viceroy of India, Archibald Wavell, in 1945. He designed the plan to break the political deadlock between the All-India Muslim League and the Indian National Congress. The main aim of the conference was to create a new Executive Council that would include representatives from different political communities and give Indians a greater role in governance.

The Wavell Plan

- Reconstitution of the Viceroy's Executive Council with equal representation for Hindus and Muslims.
- Appointment of an Indian as the Defense Member to give Indians more say in wartime administration.
- Exclusion of the issue of independence or partition from immediate discussions; the plan focused on interim governance.
- Provision that major portfolios would be shared between Congress and the Muslim League, while smaller communities would be given representation too.

The biggest conflict at the conference was about who had the right to represent Muslims in the new Executive Council. The All-India Muslim League, led by Quaid-i-Azam Muhammad Ali Jinnah, argued that it was the only true representative of Indian Muslims and therefore should nominate all Muslim members. While, the Indian National Congress rejected the

Wavell Plan (1945) because it did not accept the claim of the All-India Muslim League to be the sole representative of all Muslims in India. Congress also opposed the plan's system of communal representation, which divided political power between Hindus and Muslims. Moreover, it believed that giving equal representation would ignore Congress's majority support and weaken its political authority.

Because neither side was willing to change its position, negotiations reached a deadlock.

Historians often argue that the failure of the Simla Conference made it increasingly difficult to maintain a united India. Instead of resolving tensions, it deepened political divisions and prepared the ground for later events such as the elections of 1945–46 and the Cabinet Mission Plan.

Elections 1945–46

By the end of World War II, the British government realized that it could no longer continue colonial rule in India for a long time. Political pressure from Indian leaders was increasing, and new constitutional arrangements were expected. Therefore, elections were announced for the Central Legislative Assembly and Provincial Assemblies in 1945 and 1946.

At this stage, two major political parties dominated Indian politics:

- The Indian National Congress, which supported a united India.
- The All-India Muslim League, led by Quaid-i-Azam Muhammad Ali Jinnah, which demanded Pakistan based on the Two-Nation Theory.

The Muslim League fought the elections on a single, clear slogan Pakistan. Jinnah presented the elections as a choice between Muslim political independence and possible domination under a Hindu-majority government. Political rallies, newspapers, student organizations, and public speeches were used to mobilize Muslim voters.

Congress, on the other hand, campaigned for a united and independent India, emphasizing nationalism rather than communal identity. However, Under the leadership of Muhammad Ali Jinnah, the Muslim League won a majority of Muslim-reserved seats in both central and provincial legislatures. This victory proved that the League had become the sole representative of Muslims and strengthened its demand for the creation of Pakistan.

Result of the Elections;

It also gained major victories in Muslim constituencies in provinces like Bengal, Punjab, and Sindh.

Provincial Assembly Elections (1946)

Result of Provincial Assembly Elections (1946)				
Province	Total Seats	Muslim League Wins	Approx. %	Political Significance
Bengal	119	113	95%	League formed government; strong Pakistan support
Punjab	86	73	85%	Became largest Muslim party despite coalition politics
Sindh	34	27	9%	Strengthened League influence
NWFP	36	17	47%	Congress performed better here (regional variation)
Assam (Muslim Seats)	34	31	91%	Supported grouping with Muslim provinces
Total	492	425–430	85–90%	Massive Muslim political consolidation

Table: 9.1 The result of Provincial Assembly Elections (1946)

Political Importance of the Elections

The elections of 1945–46 had several major consequences: like

1. Strengthened Jinnah's Leadership:

Jinnah emerged as the undisputed spokesman of Muslims in negotiations with the British government.

2. Changed British Policy:

The British recognized that any constitutional plan had to include the Muslim League because it had proven its popular support.

3. Increased Political Polarization:

The clear division between Congress and the Muslim League made compromise more difficult and pushed politics closer to partition.

The Cabinet Mission (1946)

After the Elections of 1945–46, it became clear that Indian politics was deeply divided. The Muslim League had won most Muslim seats and demanded Pakistan, while Congress still supported a united India with a strong central government. The British government realized that it needed a final constitutional plan before transferring power.

In March 1946, Britain sent three senior ministers, Lord Pethick-Lawrence, Sir Stafford Cripps, and A. V. Alexander to India. Together, they formed what is known as the Cabinet Mission. The plan included both short-term and long-term proposals. In the short term, it suggested forming an Interim Government, while in the long term, it proposed a system with a weak center and strong provinces.

Main Proposals of the Cabinet Mission Plan

Its key points included:

- India would remain a single union, responsible mainly for defense, foreign affairs, and communications.
- Provinces would form three groups:
 - o Group A: Hindu-majority provinces
 - o Group B: Muslim-majority provinces of the northwest
 - o Group C: Bengal and Assam
- Provinces would have significant autonomy and could later reconsider their position.

In addition to its constitutional proposals, the Cabinet Mission Plan suggested the formation of an Interim Government at the centre. The Interim Government was to include major political parties, especially the Indian National Congress and the All-India Muslim League. It was meant to act as a temporary government until a new constitution was prepared. The government would work under the existing system but with more participation of Indian leaders in running the country. The Viceroy would remain the head, while Indian ministers would manage most of the important departments. The Muslim League initially accepted the plan because it allowed Muslim-majority provinces to act together, which could eventually lead to Pakistan in practice, even if not immediately in name.

Reaction of Political Parties

The Muslim League, led by Quaid-i-Azam Muhammad Ali Jinnah, saw the grouping system as a way to protect Muslim political rights.

The Indian National Congress accepted the idea of a united India but interpreted the grouping arrangement differently, favoring a strong central government.

Why Did the Cabinet Mission Fail?

The plan collapsed because Congress and the Muslim League could not agree on how it should be implemented. Congress wanted the provinces to be free from permanent groupings, while the Muslim League insisted that grouping was essential for Muslim political security.

When Congress announced its interpretation of the plan, the Muslim League felt that its position had been undermined and withdrew its acceptance. This marked the failure of the last major attempt to maintain a united India through constitutional compromise.

Importance of the Cabinet Mission in the Pakistan Movement

Even though the mission failed, it played a very important role in history:

1. It showed that political unity between Congress and the Muslim League had become extremely difficult.
2. It convinced many leaders that partition might be the only solution to avoid continuous political conflict.
3. It strengthened the idea that Muslims required a separate political structure to protect their interests.

Direct Action Day

After the Cabinet Mission Plan (1946) failed, political relations between Congress and the Muslim League became extremely tense. The Muslim League believed that Congress was trying to weaken Muslim political rights by changing the interpretation of the plan, especially regarding provincial groupings and autonomy.

Quaid-i-Azam Muhammad Ali Jinnah argued that peaceful negotiations had not produced a satisfactory solution. Therefore, the Muslim League announced that Muslims would demonstrate their political power through Direct Action in 16 August, 1946. For a peaceful show of unity and protest to support the demand for Pakistan.

Unfortunately, the situation quickly turned violent in some areas particularly in Bengal. Communal riots broke out in Calcutta and later spread to other parts of India. Thousands of people lost their lives.

Historians emphasize that the violence reflected the already fragile political atmosphere rather than the original intention of the Muslim League's leadership. Because of these

developments, Direct Action Day is often seen as a turning point that pushed events closer to the Mountbatten Plan and the creation of Pakistan.

Mountbatten Partition Plan (1947)

By early 1947, political tensions in India had reached a critical point. The failure of the Cabinet Mission Plan and the communal violence that followed Direct Action Day convinced the British government that maintaining control over India was becoming impossible. To manage the transfer of power, Britain appointed Lord Louis Mountbatten as the last Viceroy of India in March 1947.

Mountbatten held meetings with major political leaders, including Quaid-i-Azam Muhammad Ali Jinnah, Jawaharlal Nehru, and Mahatma Gandhi. After studying the political situation, he concluded that the differences between Congress and the Muslim League were too deep to be resolved within a single State. So, gave his Plan which is also known as 3June Plan in History.

Main Features of the Mountbatten Plan (June 3, 1947)

On 3 June 1947, Lord Mountbatten announced a plan to divide British India into two independent countries: India and Pakistan. This plan suggested that areas with Muslim majorities would become Pakistan, while Hindu-majority areas would remain India. It also proposed the division of important provinces like Punjab and Bengal through boundary commissions, and allowed princely states to choose which country they wanted to join. Most importantly, it set a quick deadline for independence in August 1947, showing that the British wanted to leave India as soon as possible.

This plan was very important because it provided a clear and final solution to the long political conflict between the All-India Muslim League and the Indian National Congress. Muhammad Ali Jinnah accepted the plan because it ensured the creation of Pakistan, even though partition would bring challenges and sacrifices. Congress leaders also agreed, as they realized that partition was the only practical way to end political deadlock and gain independence.

The 3 June Plan was both a solution and a tragedy. It successfully led to independence, but it also caused mass migration, violence, and human suffering during partition. Therefore, it remains one of the most significant and far-reaching decisions in South Asian history.

Independence and Partition (1947)

After the acceptance of the Mountbatten Plan, the process of dividing British India began quickly. The Radcliffe Commission was formed to draw the boundaries between India and Pakistan. However, because the timeline was extremely short, many decisions were made in haste. This created deep resentment and led to disputes, making the partition process more painful for Pakistan.

On 14 August 1947, Pakistan emerged as an independent state, followed by India's independence on 15 August 1947. Quaid-i-Azam Muhammad Ali Jinnah became the first Governor-General of Pakistan, and the new nation began its journey under very challenging circumstances.

Concluding Remarks

The final phase of the Pakistan Movement (1940–1947) represents one of the most decisive periods in the history of South Asia. During these crucial years, the demand for a separate homeland evolved from a constitutional proposal into a powerful mass movement grounded in ideology, political organization, and strategic leadership of Quaid-i-Azam Muhammad Ali Jinnah. Under the visionary guidance, the Muslims of the Subcontinent transformed their political aspirations into achievable goal. Thus, the study of this period allows for a critical understanding of how ideas, leadership, democratic mandate, and political negotiation collectively shaped the emergence of Pakistan.